

1. Which of the following airports in India has the highest cargo handling capacity as of FY24:
 - (a) Kempegowda International Airport
 - (b) Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport
 - (c) Indira Gandhi International Airport
 - (d) Rajiv Gandhi International Airport

2. Consider the following institutions :
 1. Exim Bank
 2. National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)
 3. Small Industrial Development Bank of India (SIDBI)
 4. National Housing Bank

How many of the above are accorded 'All India Financial Institution' (AIFI) status' by the Reserve Bank of India?

 - (a) Only one
 - (b) Only two
 - (c) Only three
 - (d) All four

3. Consider the following statements:

Statement I: In India, the current Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) is near-universal at the primary and the secondary levels and the efforts are underway to bridge the gaps at the higher secondary levels of schooling.

Statement II: The National Education Policy, 2020 aims to achieve a 100% GER across all levels of schooling by 2030.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

 - (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I
 - (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I
 - (c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
 - (d) Statement-I incorrect but Statement-II is correct

4. Consider the following statements:
 1. Agricultural Technology Management Agency (ATMA) is a central-sector scheme that shares the latest agricultural technologies to boost production.
 2. Kisan Call Centre is an 11-digit toll-free service where a farm tele advisor answers farmers' queries in regional languages.
 3. The Agriculture Infrastructure Fund boosts farm gate infrastructure by providing medium-term debt financing for community farming projects.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

 - (a) 1 and 2 only
 - (b) 2 and 3 only
 - (c) 1 and 3 only
 - (d) 1, 2 and 3

5. Which of the following organizations has developed an India-specific Economic policy uncertainty index?
 - (a) NITI Aayog
 - (b) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
 - (c) World Economic Forum
 - (d) Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations (ICRIER)

6. Consider the following statements regarding the performance of Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) in India over the past decade:
 1. The Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) ratio was never more than 10% in the last 10 years.
 2. The GNPA ratio has declined consistently in the last five years.
 3. The Capital-to-Risk Weighted Assets Ratio (CRAR) was never below 10% in the last 10 years.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

 - (a) Only one
 - (b) Only two
 - (c) All three
 - (d) None

7. Consider the following statements regarding the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) :
1. Information Utilities (IUs) under IBC help store financial data and can be used to verify defaults in insolvency cases.
 2. The National Company Law Tribunal serves as the Adjudicating Authority (AA) under the IBC, as well as for cases under the Companies Act 2013 and Competition Law.
 3. The maximum time period for corporate insolvency resolution process (CIRP) under IBC is 180 days.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

8. With reference to the Weather information and Network Data System (WINDS), consider the following statements:

1. The Ministry of Earth Sciences has initiated the weather information network and data system (WINDS) to generate long-term, hyper-local weather data.
2. WINDS has been incorporated in PM Fasal Bima Yojna to enhance transparency and accuracy in insurance claim settlement.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

9. Consider the following statements regarding GIFT International Financial Services Centre:

1. It is classified as a non-resident zone under the Foreign Exchange Management Regulations.
2. Recently, GIFT International Financial Services Centre reached the top 10 position in the 'Global Financial Centres Index 36' (GFCI 36).
3. Domestic banks are not permitted to operate in GIFT International Financial Services Centre.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 2 and 3 only

10. Consider the following components of Government expenditure:

1. Loans given to Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) for capacity expansion.
2. Interest payments on Government borrowings.
3. Grants-in-aid given to States and Union Territories for capital asset creation.
4. Proceeds from disinvestment of Public Sector Enterprises (PSEs).

How many of the above are components of Capital Expenditure?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) Only three
- (d) All four

11. Which of the following are the effects of geo-economic fragmentation:

1. Trade-restrictive measures cover a larger share of global trade.
2. Foreign direct investment (FDI) increasingly flows toward countries with similar geopolitical alignments.
3. The overall cost of global output declines.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

12. Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: The government plans to achieve a fiscal deficit of 4.4% of GDP by 2025-26.

Statement-II: The Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) Act mandates that the fiscal deficit should be gradually reduced in the long run to ensure macroeconomic stability.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
- (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
- (c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
- (d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

13. As per the Economic Survey 2024-25, which of the following statements about inflation in India in the last two years is/are correct?

1. Food inflation in India was driven by a few food items such as vegetables and pulses.
2. India's food inflation rate has remained firm, diverging from global trends of stable or declining food inflation.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

14. Arrange the following types of taxes in increasing order based on their contribution to total tax revenue as per Union Budget 2025-26:

1. Corporate Tax
2. Goods and Services Tax (GST)
3. Personal Income Tax
4. Customs Duty

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 4 -3 -2 -1
- (b) 4 -2 -3 -1
- (c) 3 -4 -2 -1
- (d) 4 -3 -1 -2

15. Consider the following statements regarding the implications of globalisation since the 1980s:

1. The global trade-to-GDP ratio has doubled in 2012 compared to that of 1980.
2. The global FDI inflow increased more than doubled in 2019 compared to that of 1980.
3. The global economy has grown over USD 100 trillion in nominal terms in 2022.
4. The extreme poverty rate of the global population fell below 5% in 2019.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1 and 4 only

16. The term 'Copenhagen Framework' is sometimes mentioned in the news is related to

- (a) A global initiative to regulate climate finance and carbon markets.
- (b) A framework that focuses on enhancing citizen participation in data governance.
- (c) An agreement focused on maritime security and trade in the Indo-Pacific region.
- (d) A policy framework to promote sustainable urban development and smart cities.

17. Consider the following statements:

Statement I: In developed countries, the transition to renewable energy has been tardy, forcing a return.

to fossil fuels to ensure stable supply and address rising electricity prices.

Statement II: The intermittent nature of renewables often requires backup fossil fuel plants to ensure grid stability.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I
- (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I
- (c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
- (d) Statement-I incorrect but Statement-II is correct

18. What is the primary objective of the Gyan Bharatam Mission, as announced in the Union Budget 2025-26?

- (a) To promote digital literacy and expand broadband access in rural India
- (b) To establish new educational institutions focused on artificial intelligence and emerging technologies
- (c) To provide financial assistance for students pursuing higher education
- (d) To document, preserve, and create a digital repository of India's manuscript heritage

19. Which of the following is the largest employer in India's renewable sector?

- (a) Solar Heating and Cooling
- (b) Wind Power
- (c) Solar Photovoltaic
- (d) Hydropower

- 20.** Consider the following statements:
1. More than 30 crore organised and unorganised workers have registered on the eShram portal.
 2. All schemes of different central ministries have been integrated with the eShram.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 21.** The Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) results for the FY23 highlight a continued increase in the number of large factories i.e., those employing more than 100 workers. In this context, consider the following statements regarding the large factories in India:
1. Large factories accounts for more than 20% of all operational factories.
 2. Large factories accounts for about 80% of total workforce.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 22.** What is the target (in gigawatts) of nuclear power capacity by 2047 according to the Union Budget 2025-26?
- (a) 50 GW (gigawatts)
(b) 75 GW (gigawatts)
(c) 100 GW (gigawatts)
(d) 150 GW (gigawatts)

- 23.** Consider the following statements regarding the road network in India:
1. The share of National Highways is more than 35% in the overall road freight traffic.
 2. The share of National Highways is more than that of the State Highways in the total road network.
 3. India has the second largest road network in the world.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

- 24.** Which of the following statements is/are correct about e-commerce exports from India?
1. India's e-commerce market makes up about 20 percent of the global market.
 2. Under the GST regime, e-commerce exports are treated as zero-rated supplies, making them eligible for GST refunds.
 3. The Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) 2023 does not include any provisions related to e-commerce exports.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

25. As per the economic survey, how many of the following are the sub-sectors of industrial sector?
1. Manufacturing
 2. Logistics
 3. Mining and Quarrying
 4. Construction
- Select the correct answer using the code given bellow.
- (a) Only one
 - (b) Only two
 - (c) Only three
 - (d) All four
26. Consider the following statements regarding the Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME) sector in India:
1. According to the Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises Development (MSMED) Act, 2006, a medium enterprise is defined as one with an investment in plant and machinery between ₹10 crore and ₹25 crore.
 2. The MSME sector contributes more than 40% to India's merchandise exports.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
 - (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2
 - (d) Neither 1 nor 2
27. Consider the following statements regarding Self-employed workers in India:
1. More than 70% of the total workforce is Self-employed in India.
 2. The proportion of self-employed workers in the workforce has continuously decreased since 2017-18.
- Which of the statements given above is/are **not** correct?
- (a) 1 only
 - (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2
 - (d) Neither 1 nor 2
28. Within the Services sector, which of the following services has the maximum buoyancy during the last decade (FY13-FY23)?
- (a) Information and computer-related services
 - (b) Financial services
 - (c) Transport services
 - (d) Insurance and Pension services
29. As per the Economic Survey (2024-25), which of the following clean energy sources heavily relies on stable fossil fuel supply chains and the availability of sulfuric acid?
- (a) Hydrogen production via electrolysis of fossil fuels
 - (b) Lithium-ion battery
 - (c) Biofuel production from algae
 - (d) Nuclear energy
30. Consider the following statements:
1. In India, Services sector contributes more than 50% to the total GVA.
 2. The average growth of the Services sector in the last three years has been more than 8%.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
 - (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2
 - (d) Neither 1 nor 2
31. Which of the following best describes the term 'reinstatement effect' in an economy?
- (a) The increase in labor demand and share due to technological innovation.
 - (b) The movement from the older level of expenditure and taxation to a new and higher level
 - (c) The reduction in employment as automation replaces tasks
 - (d) The revival of loss-making PSUs by the Government

- 32.** Consider the following statements:
1. The Department of Economic Affairs in the Ministry of Finance prepares the budget.
 2. The term "Budget" has been mentioned two times in the Constitution.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 33.** Friendshoring and Nearshoring, sometimes seen in the news, are related to:

- (a) Outflow of Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) from the stock market of one country to another due to changes in monetary policy.
- (b) Shifting of manufacturing bases to low-tax countries to minimize corporate tax liabilities.
- (c) Restructuring of global supply chains based on geopolitical and geographical considerations.
- (d) Climate change mitigation strategies adopted by the European Union.

- 34.** Consider the following conditions:

1. The Sector is yet to attain market saturation
2. Automation can aid productivity and employment gains
3. An increase in labour productivity may come with lower costs

Which of the above is/are correct with respect to the high demand elasticity of a sector?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

- 35.** Consider the following statements regarding the 'Composite Index of Agricultural Sustainability':

1. The Composite Index of Agricultural Sustainability (CIAS) was developed by the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research to map the vulnerability of Indian agriculture towards climate change.
2. States in the Indo-Gangetic Plains, including Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, and Haryana, are at a higher risk of climate change impacts.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 36.** With reference to the Economic Survey 2024-25, which of the following best describes the term 'lower tail dependence'?

- (a) Reduction in crop yield due to rainfall deficiency
- (b) Increase in corporate profits due to low inflation
- (c) Reduction in floor area due to high real estate prices
- (d) Increase in export volume due to a shift in the global supply chain towards India

- 37.** Consider the following statements regarding deficit financing in India:

1. Securities against small savings constitute a large share in deficit financing.
2. Short-term borrowings (T-Bills) have shown a steady increase in the last five years.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

38. Consider the following initiatives:

1. PM SHRI
2. STARS
3. PARAKH
4. ULLAS
5. PM POSHAN

Through how many of the above initiatives does the government aim to achieve the objectives of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020?

- (a) Only two
- (b) Only three
- (c) Only four
- (d) All five

39. According to the Economic survey 2024-25, there is an inflationary pressure on onions and tomatoes. Which of the following factors are driving inflation in these crops?

1. Production seasonality
2. Perishability
3. Regional concentration of production

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2, and 3

40. According to data from the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), FDI inflows into India have surpassed the USD 1 trillion mark from April 2000 to September 2024. Arrange the following sectors in descending order of their share in total FDI equity inflows during the first half of FY25:

1. Automobile Industry
2. Trading
3. Cement & gypsum products
4. Computer software & hardware
5. Non-conventional energy

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 4 – 1 – 2 – 5 – 3
- (b) 4 – 2 – 5 – 3 – 1
- (c) 1 – 4 – 5 – 2 – 3
- (d) 1 – 4 – 5 – 3 – 2

41. With reference to the Economic Survey 2024-25, consider the following statements:

1. Flospan is a recirculating aquaculture system that promotes freshwater fisheries' growth.
2. The share of processed food exports within agri-food exports has declined after the COVID-19 pandemic.
3. The food processing sector is excluded from the purview of the Production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme.

How many statements given above are correct?

- (a) One only
- (b) Two only
- (c) All three
- (d) None

42. In the context of India, consider the following :

1. Industrial Outlook Survey
2. Rural Economic Conditions and Sentiments Survey
3. Financial Stability Report

How many of the above are released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

43. Consider the following statements with reference to the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) report:

1. According to PLFS, the Unemployment Rate (usual status) in India is 2.3% in 2023-24.
2. For a person to be categorised as employed as per usual status, he/she must have pursued an economic activity for the last 7 days preceding the date of the survey.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

44. Consider the following statements regarding the energy sector in India:

1. The total installed capacity of renewable energy is more than 200GW as of December 2024.
2. The share of non-fossil fuel energy in the total installed energy capacity of India has been steadily increasing for the last 5 years.
3. The daily average power supply both in rural and urban areas in India has been more than 21 hours as of December 2024.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

45. Consider the following statements regarding Unemployment Rate in India:

1. In India, Unemployment Rate (usual status) has steadily declined in the last 5 years.
2. In India, Unemployment Rate (current weekly status) has steadily declined in the last 5 years.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

46. Consider the following statements with reference to the Economic Survey 2024-2025:

1. India's per capita carbon emissions are one-third of the global average.
2. India is the seventh most vulnerable country to climate change.
3. In the FY 2022-23, India's adaptation expenditure was more than 5% of its GDP.
4. In India, climate adaptation efforts are primarily financed through domestic resources.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) Only three
- (d) All four

47. Consider the following statements regarding social sector expenditure during (FY 21 to FY 25) in India:

1. The general government's social services expenditure grew at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 15% from FY21 to FY25.
2. Expenditure on health has grown at a higher CAGR than education expenditure.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

48. Consider the following statements regarding Reverse Charge Mechanism (RCM) under GST:

1. In RCM, the liability of tax payment is transferred to the recipient/receiver instead of the supplier.
2. The ITC on the tax amount paid under RCM cannot be claimed.
3. It is applicable in the case of purchase from an unregistered dealer.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1 and 2 only

49. Consider the following statements:

1. India's installed non-fossil fuel electricity capacity is more than 50% of the total capacity.
2. The projects under the Green Energy Corridor aim to establish an intra-state transmission system that enhances grid capabilities for renewable energy.
3. The National Bioenergy Programme supports the manufacturing of briquettes and pellets and bagasse-based cogeneration in industries.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

50. Consider the following statements:

1. No adult worker is allowed to work in a factory for more than forty-eight hours in any week.
2. No worker is allowed to work overtime for more than seven consecutive days.
3. The total number of overtime hours in any quarter shall not exceed seventy-five.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct regarding the Factories Act, 1948?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

51. Consider the following pairs:

<i>Status</i>	<i>Description</i>
1. Open Defecation Free (ODF)	: Ensures access to toilets and eliminates open defecation
2. Open Defecation Free + (ODF+)	: Focus on complete faecal sludge management
3. Open Defecation Free ++ (ODF++)	: Focus on clean, hygienic and functional nature of toilet
4. Water+	: Focus on liquid waste management and reuse of treated wastewater

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) Only three
- (d) All four

- 52.** Consider the following statements:
1. The Dependency ratio is the number of children (age 0-14 years) and older persons (age 60 years and above) per lakh working age population.
 2. The Dependency ratio is more than 50% in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 53.** Consider the following statements regarding India's Current Account performance in the last 5 years:

1. India has consistently recorded a Current Account Deficit (CAD) in the last 5 years without any surplus.
2. CAD, as a percentage of GDP, has shown a consistent declining trend over the last 5 years.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 54.** Which of the following is a primary aim of the REPowerEU plan?

- (a) To establish a single European currency backed by renewable energy reserves
- (b) To reduce dependence on Russian fossil fuels and accelerate the transition to clean energy
- (c) To build nuclear power plants in every EU member state by 2047
- (d) To promote the extraction of natural gas to reduce energy imports

- 55.** With reference to the Technical textiles, consider the following statements:

1. They are always made from synthetic fibers.
2. India is a net importer of technical textiles.
3. India's technical textile industry ranks fifth globally.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

- 56.** Consider the following statements regarding the Aatmanirbharta in Pulses Mission announced in Union Budget 2025-26:

1. The mission has a six-year tenure and focuses on Tur, Urad, and Masoor pulses.
2. It aims to develop climate-resilient seeds and enhance protein content in pulses.
3. The mission ensures unlimited procurement of selected pulses for four years through Food Corporation of India.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

- 57.** The Commodity Markets Outlook is released by which of the following organizations?

- (a) Food and Agriculture Organization
- (b) World Trade Organization (WTO)
- (c) World Bank
- (d) International Fund for Agricultural Development

58. How many of the following are the member countries of the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries plus (OPEC+)?
1. USA
 2. Russia
 3. South Sudan
 4. Brunei
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.
- (a) Only one
 - (b) Only two
 - (c) Only three
 - (d) All four
59. Aadharshila, launched by the Ministry of Women and Child Development, is a/an
- (a) Initiative to promote entrepreneurship among rural women through self-help groups.
 - (b) Scheme to provide nutritional support and health services to pregnant women.
 - (c) Digital platform for child welfare and protection services.
 - (d) National Curriculum for Early Childhood Care and Education
60. Consider the following statements regarding the Consumer Food Price Index (CFPI):
1. It is a statistical measure used to track changes in the wholesale prices of food items.
 2. It is calculated monthly by the Central Statistics Office, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MOSPI).
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
 - (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2
 - (d) Neither 1 nor 2
61. The results of the Household Consumption Expenditure Survey, 2023-24 highlight the narrowing urban-rural gap in consumption expenditure. In this context, which of the following factors primarily contributed to the increased monthly per capita expenditure (MPCE) in rural areas of India in 2023–24?
- (a) Rising agricultural exports
 - (b) Migration to urban centers
 - (c) Expansion of direct benefit transfers
 - (d) Declining food prices
62. As per the Economic Survey 2024-25, which Indian state had the highest share of own tax revenue (OTR) as a percentage of their total tax revenue in 2024?
- (a) Maharashtra
 - (b) Karnataka
 - (c) Telangana
 - (d) Tamil Nadu
63. Which of the statements is correct regarding the Sovereign Green Bonds?
- (a) Sovereign Green Bonds are debt securities to fund projects that have positive environmental benefits.
 - (b) The proceeds from these bonds are exclusively allocated to renewable energy projects.
 - (c) The Union Budget 2024-25 announced the first issuance of Sovereign Green Bonds.
 - (d) Both central government and state governments can issue Sovereign Green Bonds.
64. The term ‘Matsya-6000’ is sometimes mentioned in the context of which one of the following?
- (a) India's deep-sea manned submersible for ocean exploration.
 - (b) A new variety of genetically modified fish for aquaculture.
 - (c) An advanced naval stealth submarine developed for maritime security.
 - (d) A project aimed at artificial coral reef restoration in Indian waters.

65. Consider the following statements regarding the revenue receipts of Indian states in 2024:
1. For all the Indian states, GST was the main source of revenue in their own revenue receipts.
 2. Tamil Nadu had the highest share of non-tax revenue in its own revenue receipts among all the states.
 3. Maharashtra had the highest share of stamps and registration fees in its own revenue receipts among all the states.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 3 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3
66. In 2024, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) introduced a measure to improve credit access for small and marginal farmers by:
- (a) Increasing the limit for collateral-free agricultural loans from ₹1.6 lakh to ₹2 lakh
(b) Reducing the interest rate on agricultural loans to 8% per annum
(c) Introducing a new loan waiver scheme for small and marginal farmers
(d) Allowing banks to issue zero-interest loans up to 3 lakhs to marginal farmers under KCC
67. With reference to the Economic Survey 2024-25, consider the following statements:
1. In the financial year 2023, the milk industry generated the maximum revenue among various branches of the livestock sector.
 2. The MAITRI scheme under the Rashtriya Gokul Mission delivers quality artificial insemination services to farmers at their doorsteps.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

68. Arrange the following types of deficits in increasing order as a percentage of GDP (as per Budget 2025-26):
1. Primary Deficit (PD)
 2. Revenue Deficit (FD)
 3. Fiscal Deficit (FD)
 4. Effective Revenue Deficit (ERD)
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.
- (a) 4-3-2-1
(b) 4-1-2-3
(c) 1-2-3-4
(d) 4-2-1-3
69. Consider the following statements:
1. In India, the labour force participation rate (LFPR)-usual status is continuously increasing in the last 5 years.
 2. In India, the worker-to-population ratio (WPR)-usual status is continuously increasing in the last 5 years.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
70. Consider the following statements:
1. In India, services exports as percentage of services GVA (net of public administration) have been continuously increasing in the last 5 years.
 2. Services exports as percentage of services GVA (net of public administration) is more than 20% in FY 23.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

71. Consider the following statements regarding Indian Pharmaceutical Industry:
1. It is the world's third-largest by volume in production.
 2. India is net importer due to its dependence on Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (APIs).
 3. The industry is covered under the Production Linked Incentives (PLI) scheme.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2, and 3
72. Consider the following statements with respect to the port and shipping sector in India:
1. The average container turnaround time in major ports has reduced to 10 hours in FY25.
 2. The VadHAVAN Mega Port is the first major port of Gujarat.
 3. The National Maritime Heritage Complex is being constructed in Lothal.
- How many of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None
73. Which of the following is the aim of the "Tim Tim Tare" initiative?
- (a) To impart essential life skills to adolescent students across India.
(b) To provide nutritional supplements to school-going children.
(c) To train adolescent girls in vocational skills for future employment.
(d) To offer financial incentives to parents for enrolling their children in primary schools.

74. Consider the following statements regarding the National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP):
1. It was launched with an investment target of Rs 111 lakh crore by 2030.
 2. The funding for NIP is exclusively provided by the Central Government.
 3. Under it, more than 50% of funding is mobilized by monetization of the Central Government's core assets.
- Which of the statements given above are **not** correct?
- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3
75. Which of the following statements regarding Non-Tariff Measures (NTMs) are correct?
1. While NTMs often increase trade costs, they can also enhance trade opportunities by boosting consumer confidence in product quality.
 2. The European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) and European Union Deforestation Regulation (EUDR) fall under NTMs.
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) None
76. Which of the following best describes the objective of BharatTradeNet (BTN)?
- (a) It is a digital platform to streamline international trade documentation and financing.
(b) It is a government initiative to promote domestic retail trade and e-commerce.
(c) It is a logistics policy framework for inland waterway transport.
(d) It is a financial subsidy scheme for small exporters.

77. Consider the following statements:
1. In 2023-24, the share of female workers in agriculture sector is more than 60%.
 2. In rural areas, the Female LFPR in agriculture sector is more than 75%.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

78. Consider the following statements:
1. The export of services grew at a trend rate of more than 10 per cent during FY14 to FY23.
 2. Computer services and business services exports account for around 70 per cent of India's services exports.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

79. The Framework for Responsible and Ethical Enablement of Artificial Intelligence (FREE-AI) was recently announced by which institution to regulate the use of AI and Machine Learning in financial services?
- (a) NITI Aayog
(b) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
(c) Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
(d) Indian Computer Emergency Response Team

80. As per the Economic Survey 2024-25, how many of the following can be attributed to the outflow of Foreign Portfolio investments (FPIs) from India?
1. Rising Geopolitical tensions
 2. Inclusion of Indian Government Bonds (IGB) in some global bond indices
 3. Cheap valuation of Chinese stocks
 4. High Valuations of Indian stocks
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.
- (a) Only One
(b) Only two
(c) Only three
(d) All four

81. Consider the following statements regarding the Makhana Board announced in Union Budget 2025-26:
1. The Makhana Board will be set up in Bihar to enhance production and value addition.
 2. The board will help in the organization of farmers into Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs).
 3. The initiative is focused on improving exports of Makhana rather than domestic processing and marketing.
- Which of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2, and 3

82. Consider the following statements regarding the Production of Tomatoes and Onions in India :

1. Majority of the production of Tomatoes and Onions occurs in Rabi season.
2. Total production of Tomatoes and Onions in India exceeded 100 million tonnes in FY23.
3. Household consumption of Tomatoes and Onions exceeded the total production in the last 3 years continuously.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

83. The Union Budget 2025-26 was presented with which of the following themes?

- (a) Viksit Bharat
- (b) India@100: Building a Sustainable Future
- (c) Amrit Kaal: Towards a Self-Reliant Economy
- (d) Sabka Vikas

84. Which of the following are part of India's Space Vision 2047?

1. Chandrayaan-4 Lunar Sample Return Mission
2. Venus Orbiter Mission
3. NISAR Mission
4. Development of Next Generation Launch Vehicle
5. Development of Reusable Launch Vehicle

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 2, 4 and 5 only
- (c) 3, 4 and 5 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 4 only

85. Consider the following statements regarding the Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) Act, 2003:

1. The FRBM Act applies to both the central and state governments, requiring them to maintain fiscal discipline.
2. The Act mandates that the central government must maintain a zero revenue deficit at all times.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

86. Consider the following statements regarding the Pradhan Mantri Dhan Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDKY):

1. It is implemented in all the 117 Aspirational Districts.
2. Apart from enhancing crop productivity, it also focuses on crop diversification and strengthening post-harvest storage.
3. The scheme provides direct income support of Rs 6000 per year to small and marginal farmers.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

87. Consider the following statements with respect to China's share in the renewable energy sector:

1. China sources three-fourths of the World's wind installed capacity.
2. China houses more than 75% of the world's battery manufacturing capacity.
3. Chinese companies process more than 90% of the world's rare earth minerals.

Which of the following statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

88. Which of the following best describes the 'Sectors to defend' in the services sector?

- (a) sectors with low-moderate export, moderate-high GVA & employment share
- (b) sectors with low export, GVA & employment share
- (c) sectors with high export & GVA, low employment share
- (d) sectors with negligible export, GVA & employment share

89. With reference to soil fertility, consider the following statements:

1. The fertigation method involves the use of liquid and water-soluble fertilizers only.
2. 'Urea Gold' is introduced to address the boron deficiency in the soil.
3. PM-PRANAM incentivizes the adoption of alternative fertilizers like Nano Diammonium phosphate to check the excessive use of chemical fertilizers.

How many statements given above are correct?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

90. Consider the following statements:

Statement I: Capital expenditure has consistently increased over the last three years, reflecting the government's focus on infrastructure development.

Statement II: A major portion of effective capital expenditure is allocated to grants-in-aid for the creation of capital assets.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
- (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
- (c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
- (d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

91. Which of the following statements best describes supercritical and ultra-supercritical technology-based power units?

- (a) They use advanced hydrogen fuel cells to generate electricity without any emissions, replacing coal from thermal power plants.
- (b) They utilize superconductors to eliminate energy loss during electricity generation in coal plants.
- (c) These are advanced coal-based power plants that operate above the critical point of water, where liquid and gas phases cease to exist separately.
- (d) They generate electricity by harnessing geothermal energy at extremely high subsurface pressures and temperatures.

- 92.** Which of the following statements about Tur dal (pigeon pea)in India is/are correct?
1. Tur is majorly a Kharif crop.
 2. India is self-sufficient in Tur dal production and does not rely on imports.
 3. Production of Tur dal has declined in the last two years compared to the last 5-year average.
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.
- (a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 2 and 3 only
- 93.** Consider the following statements regarding the fisheries sector in India:
1. Marine fisheries contribute more to the total fish production than inland fisheries.
 2. India ranks second globally in fish production and aquaculture.
 3. The fisheries sector in India contributes around 6% to the country's GDP.
- How many of the above statements are correct?
- (a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None
- 94.** Consider the following statements regarding India's stock market and market capitalization:
1. The total market capitalization of Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE)-listed stocks closed above the USD 5 trillion milestone for the first time in 2024.
 2. The BSE Market Capitalization to GDP ratio is more than 100 percent.
 3. India's Market Capitalization to Nominal GDP ratio is less than China.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

- 95.** Consider the following statements regarding India's external sector:
1. India ranks in the top five in services exports.
 2. Recently, Mexico has become the top recipient country of remittances in the world.
 3. India's foreign exchange reserves crossed the 700 billion dollar mark in 2024.
- How many of the above statements are correct?
- (a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None
- 96.** Which of the following food items were sold under the Bharat brand as part of the government's administrative measures to control food inflation?
1. Rice
 2. Wheat
 3. Moong Dal
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.
- (a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3
- 97.** Consider the following statements:
1. India's share in global services exports has been steadily rising for the last two decades.
 2. India's share in global services export is more than 5%.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

98. Consider the following statements regarding the corporate bond market in India:
1. As a percentage of GDP, the corporate bond market is less than 50 percent in India.
 2. The majority of corporate bond issuance happens through private placement rather than public offerings.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
 - (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2
 - (d) Neither 1 nor 2
99. Which of the statements is correct about the White-winged Duck?
- (a) The White-winged Duck is classified as 'Endangered' under the IUCN Red List.
 - (b) It is widely distributed across the entire Indian subcontinent, especially the Western Ghats.
 - (c) It is a nocturnal bird that is active mainly during the night.
 - (d) It is the state bird of Karnataka.
100. Fluoxetine (Prozac), sometimes seen in the news, is:
- (a) A type of antibiotic that treats bacterial infections
 - (b) A serotonin selective reuptake inhibitor used as an antidepressant
 - (c) A drug used to treat cardiovascular diseases
 - (d) A medication to improve reproductive traits in aquatic species

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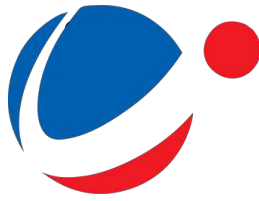
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ANSWERS & EXPLANATIONS

GENERAL STUDIES (P) TEST – 4729 (2025)

Q 1.C

- Cargo handling capacity refers to the maximum amount of cargo (freight, mail, and express parcels) that an airport or cargo terminal can handle within a given time period. It depends on several factors, including infrastructure, technology, and operational efficiency.
- The Cargo handling capacity at the airport was at 7.4 million metric tonnes in FY22, 7.5MMT in FY23 and 8 MMT in FY24. Therefore, the cargo handling capacity has steadily increased since FY22.
- **As of the FY24, the top Indian airports by cargo handling capacity are:**
 - **Indira Gandhi International Airport: 1MMT. Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.**
 - Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport: 0.8MMT
 - Kempegowda International Airport: 0.43MMT
- Another flagship scheme of the Ministry of Aviation is the Ude Desh ka Aam Naagrik (UDAN) scheme. Under the Regional Connectivity Scheme (UDAN), 619 routes connecting 88 airports, including two water aerodromes and 13 heliports, have been operationalised so far.

Q 2.D

- Given the need for a long-term capital provider with a holistic sectoral mandate, as opposed to the niche mandate of other DFIs, the National Bank for Financing and Infrastructure Development (NaBFID) was established as an infrastructure-focused DFI through NaBFID Act, 2021.
- **The RBI accorded it an 'All India Financial Institution' (AIFI) status on 8 March 2022, making it the fifth AIFI after NABARD, Small Industrial Development Bank of India (SIDBI), NHB and Exim Bank. NaBFID has both financial and developmental objectives.**
- Its financial objective is to lend or invest, directly or indirectly, and seek to attract investment from private sector investors and institutional investors in infrastructure projects to foster sustainable economic development in India.
 - The developmental objective of the institution is to coordinate with the central and state governments, regulators, financial institutions, institutional investors, and other relevant stakeholders.
- NaBFID has sanctioned ₹1.3 lakh crore loans as of 30 September 2024. The road and energy sector, including renewable energy, account for over three-fourths of loans sanctioned.
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 3.D

- India's school education system serves 24.8 crore students across 14.72 lakh schools with 98 lakh teachers (UDISE+ 2023-24). Government schools make up 69 per cent of the total, enrolling 50 per cent of students and employing 51 per cent of teachers, while private schools account for 22.5 per cent, enrolling 32.6 per cent of students and employing 38 per cent of teachers. **The National Education Policy, 2020 aims for a 100 percent Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) by 2030. The GER is near-universal at the primary (93 per cent) and the efforts are underway to bridge the gaps at the secondary (77.4 percent) and higher secondary level (56.2 per cent), driving the nation closer to its vision of inclusive and equitable education for all. Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**
- School dropout rates have steadily declined in recent years, standing at 1.9 per cent for primary, 5.2 per cent for upper primary, and 14.1 per cent for secondary levels. However, challenges persist, with retention rates at 85.4 per cent for primary (class I to V), 78 per cent for elementary (classes I to VIII), 63.8 per cent for secondary (classes I to X), and 45.6 per cent for higher secondary (classes I to XII). Improvements in basic facilities and infrastructure, including medical check-ups, sanitation, and information and communication technologies (ICT) availability, have been notable, reflecting a positive trend in school infrastructure development.

Q 4.B

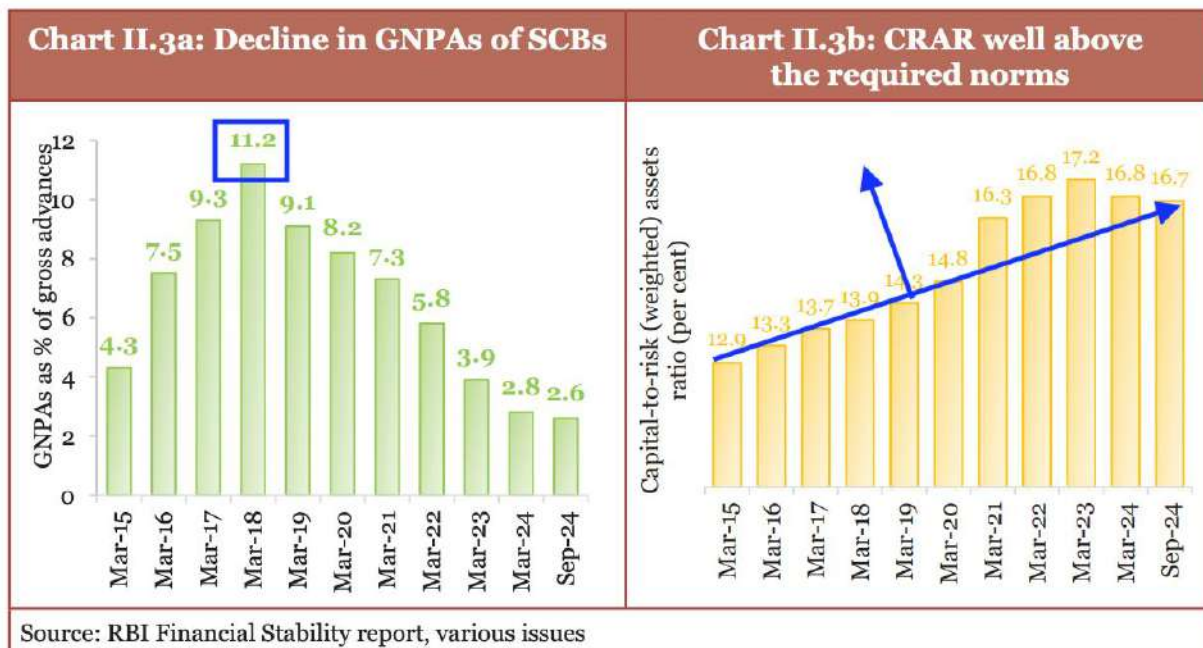
- **Centrally Sponsored Scheme ‘Support to State Extension Programs for Extension Reforms,’** popularly known as **ATMA Scheme**, has been under implementation since 2005. The scheme promotes a decentralized farmer-friendly extension system in the country. **The objectives of the Scheme are to support the State Government’s efforts and to make available the latest agricultural technologies and good agricultural practices in different thematic areas of agriculture and allied areas to farmers through different extension activities viz; Farmers Training, Demonstrations, Exposure Visits, Kisan Mela, Mobilization of Farmers Groups and organizing Farm Schools, etc. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- In order to harness the potential of ICT in Agriculture, the Ministry of Agriculture launched the scheme **"Kisan Call Centres (KCCs)"** on January 21, 2004. The project's main aim is to answer farmers' queries on a telephone call in their own dialect. These call centers work in 14 different locations across the states and the UTs. A countrywide common **eleven-digit Toll-Free number, 1800-180-1551**, has been allotted for the Kisan Call Centre. This number is accessible through mobile phones and landlines of all telecom networks, including private service providers. Replies to the farmers' queries are given in 22 local languages. **Call center services are available from 6.00 am to 10.00 pm on all seven days of the week at each KCC location.** Kisan Call Centre agents, known as **Farm Tele Advisors (FTAs)**, are graduates or above (i.e., PG or Doctorate) in Agriculture or allied (Horticulture, Animal Husbandry, Fisheries, Poultry, Bee-keeping, Sericulture, Aquaculture, Agricultural Engineering, Agricultural Marketing, Bio-technology, Home Science, etc. and possess excellent communication skills in the respective local language. A **Kisan Knowledge Management System (KKMS)** has been developed to facilitate correct, consistent, and quick replies to farmers' queries and capture all the details of their calls. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The **Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF)** was launched in 2020 to boost farm-gate infrastructure further and improve private sector involvement. This fund provides **medium-term debt financing** for post-harvest management and community farming projects, offering interest subvention and credit guarantees and supporting various projects such as custom hiring centers, processing units, warehouses, and cold storage facilities. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 5.B

- **The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has developed a policy uncertainty index specifically for India, utilizing various global indices (e.g. Geopolitical Risk (GPR) index, Trade Policy Uncertainty (TPU) index, Global Economic Policy Uncertainty (GEPU) index).**
- **This index leverages internet search data from Google Trends to assess policy uncertainty from domestic and international events. Furthermore, the index is updated in real time.**
- When faced with heightened uncertainty, it is typical of economic agents to 'search' for more information. **This Google Trends-based uncertainty index (India-GUI) developed by RBI leverages this behavior to measure overall uncertainty by using internet search volumes for a list of keywords about fiscal, monetary, and trade policy in India.** The policy-related keywords are curated, based on mentions in central bank policy statements as well as coverage in the financial press.
- **Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 6.B

- **The Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) ratio of SCBs has declined consistently from its peak in FY18 to a 12- year low of 2.6 per cent at the end of September 2024. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - Lower slippages and a reduction in outstanding GNPA through recoveries, upgradations, and write-offs have led to this decrease.
- Lower GNPA and higher provisions accumulated in recent years also contributed to a decline in net NPAs at around 0.6 percent at the end of September 2024.
 - Improvements in asset quality parameters were observed across all major bank groups.



- Hence statement 1 is not correct and statement 3 is correct.

Q 7.B

- The IBC consolidates laws related to insolvency and reorganization of companies, partnerships, and individuals.
- The institutional mechanism of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code includes the following:
 - Insolvency Professions (IPs) are a specialized cadre of licensed professionals who administer the process of insolvency resolution, manage the debtors' assets, and provide information for creditors to assist them in decision-making.
- Adjudicating Authorities
 - The proceedings of the resolution process are to be adjudicated by National Companies Law Tribunal (NCLT) in case of companies; and Debt Recovery Tribunal (DRT) in case of individuals.
- Committee of Creditors (CoC)
 - During the insolvency resolution process, a committee of lenders is formed to make decisions on the resolution process through voting.
- Information Utilities (IUs) were established under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) to store verified financial information.
 - These records serve as conclusive proof of default and help in speedy resolution of insolvency cases.
 - Hence statement 1 is correct.
- The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) is the Adjudicating Authority (AA) for cases under the IBC. In addition, it handles matters under the Companies Act 2013 and Competition Law.
 - Hence statement 2 is correct.
- The original time limit for CIRP was 180 days, extendable by 90 days. However, an amendment introduced a 330-day outer limit, which includes judicial proceedings.
 - Hence statement 3 is not correct.
- Corporate insolvency resolution process (CIRP) may be initiated by a financial creditor under section 7, an operational creditor under section 9 and corporate applicant of corporate debtor under section 10 of the Code.
- The minimum amount of default for initiating CIRP was ₹ 1 lakh till recently. The Government vide notification dated 24th March, 2020, has increased the minimum amount of default to ₹ 1 crore.

Q 8.B

- WINDS is a programmatic initiative to strengthen the country's weather data infrastructure and provide good-quality weather datasets from a **single digital platform**. WINDS is a national-level initiative integrating the existing infrastructure and expertise available with IMD, various State Governments, and public/private technical organizations. The **Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare** launched it

in July 2023 to harness advanced weather data analytics to provide stakeholders with actionable insight to make informed weather decisions on agriculture. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**

- **As the largest crop insurance program in the world in terms of farmer enrolment and the third-largest by premiums**, PM Fasal Bima Yojna offers comprehensive risk coverage from the pre-sowing to post-harvest stages. The scheme encourages farmers to adopt modern agricultural practices and technologies by ensuring financial stability, ultimately enhancing agricultural productivity and food security. In response to recommendations from various committees, the scheme has recently launched several technological interventions, such as **YES-TECH, WINDS, and CROPIC**. These advancements have increased transparency within the scheme ecosystem by minimizing human intervention and fostering greater trust among stakeholders, including implementing States/UTs and insurance companies. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 9.A

- The International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) is poised to play a pivotal role in India's vision for 2047. As a unified regulator, IFSCA is responsible for developing and regulating financial institutions, services, and products within India's International Financial Services Centres (IFSCs).
- GIFT IFSC has been witnessing brisk growth, having more than 720 entities across categories. **The international and domestic financial services industry is gravitating to this unique jurisdiction which benefits from unrestricted currency convertibility as it is classified as a non-resident zone under the Foreign Exchange Management Regulations. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **GIFT-IFSC has continued its ascent as a leading IFSC, improving its rank by five places in the 'Global Financial Centres Index 36' (GFCI 36), rising to 52nd position. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
 - It also achieved a notable jump in the FinTech rankings, climbing four places to rank 45. This progress reflects the concerted efforts of IFSCA in fostering a robust FinTech ecosystem.
- **The vibrant banking ecosystem in GIFT IFSC comprises foreign and domestic banks set up as branches of the parent bank operating as IFSC Banking Units (IBUs). Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
 - As of September 2024, the total asset size of IBUs crossed USD 70 billion, and the cumulative value of transactions undertaken by IBUs crossed USD 975 billion.
- The asset management ecosystem in IFSC is proliferating. It comprises 128 Fund Management Entities, 168 Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), and three Investment Advisors

Q 10.B

- Government expenditure is broadly classified into two types:
 - Capital Expenditure: Capital Expenditure refers to spending that results in the creation of assets or reduces liabilities.
 - > It is usually long-term in nature and enhances the productive capacity of the economy.
 - > Examples: Construction of infrastructure (roads, railways, bridges).
 - Revenue Expenditure: Revenue Expenditure consists of expenses that do not create assets and are incurred for day-to-day operations of the government. It is generally recurring in nature.
 - > Examples: Salaries, pensions, subsidies.
- **Analysis of Statements:**
 - **Loans given to Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) for capacity expansion .**
 - > Loans to PSUs are considered capital expenditure because they help in the creation of productive assets and expansion of infrastructure.
 - **Interest payments on government borrowings**
 - > Interest payments are recurring financial obligations and do not contribute to asset creation. Therefore, they fall under Revenue Expenditure.
 - **Grants-in-aid given to States and Union Territories for capital asset creation.**
 - > If grants are specifically meant for capital asset creation (e.g., constructing hospitals, roads, etc.), they are classified as Capital Expenditure. However, general grants for operational expenses would be Revenue Expenditure.
 - **Proceeds from disinvestment of Public Sector Enterprises (PSEs) - (Neither Capital nor Revenue Expenditure, but a Capital Receipt)**
 - > Disinvestment proceeds refer to the government selling its stake in PSEs. While this generates funds, it is considered a Capital Receipt, not an expenditure. It does not qualify as Capital Expenditure because it does not involve spending on asset creation.
- **Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 11.A

- The 'geo-economic fragmentation' (GEF) as a policy-driven reversal of global economic integration often guided by strategic considerations.
- As per the World Trade Organization (WTO)'s Trade Monitoring Report the value of trade covered by the 169 new trade-restrictive measures introduced between October 2023 and October 2024 is USD 887.7 billion, which is half a trillion dollars more than the value of trade covered by restrictions introduced in the preceding year, which stood at USD 337.1 billion. **Therefore, GEF leads to an increase in the value of trade covered under trade-restrictive measures. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The impact of GEF is seen in global FDI flows, which are increasingly concentrated among geopolitically aligned countries, particularly in strategic sectors. **This relocation of FDI increases the vulnerability of several emerging markets and developing economies. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It is estimated that the cost to global output from geo-economic fragmentation could range from 0.2 percent (in a limited fragmentation/low-cost adjustment scenario) up to 7 percent of the GDP (in a high fragmentation/high-cost adjustment scenario). **Therefore, the cost of global output is expected to increase (instead of decreasing) due to GEF. Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 12.A

- The Union Budget 2025-26 has set a target to reduce the fiscal deficit to 4.5% of GDP by 2026-27 as part of the government's fiscal consolidation roadmap. **Hence, statement-I is correct.**
 - This move aligns with the government's commitment to reducing fiscal imbalances while maintaining economic growth.
- The Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) Act, 2003, originally aimed to bring down the fiscal deficit to 3% of GDP in the long run.
 - This target has been revised multiple times, especially during economic crises and global downturns, making the reduction a gradual process.
 - The government has deviated from the FRBM-mandated fiscal deficit targets during COVID-19 and has now set a new roadmap for deficit reduction.
 - The FRBM's 3% fiscal deficit target is a long-term fiscal policy goal. **Hence, statement-II is correct.**
 - **Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I**

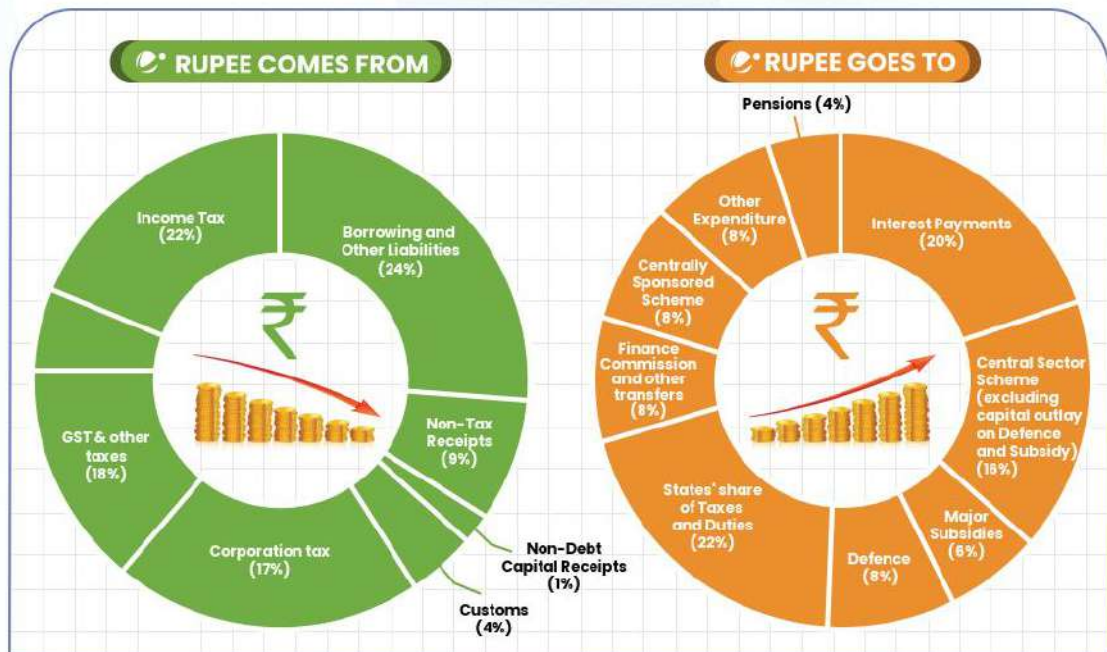
Q 13.C

- India's headline inflation, measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI), has moderated in FY25 (April-December) compared to FY24.
- This decline is primarily due to a significant decrease in core inflation, which dropped by 0.9 percentage points between FY24 and FY25 (April-December). The sharp decline in core inflation was largely driven by core services inflation.
- **Over the past two years, India's food inflation rate has remained firm, diverging from global trends of stable or declining food inflation. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - This can be attributed to factors such as supply chain disruptions exacerbated by extreme weather events and reduced harvest of some food items.
- Food inflation, measured by the CFPI, faced pressures in FY25 (April-December), primarily driven by a few food items such as vegetables and pulses.
- **Vegetables and pulses together holds a total weightage of 8.42 per cent in CPI basket.** However, their contribution to the overall inflation stood at 32.3 per cent in FY25 (April to December).
- **When Vegetables and pulses are excluded, the average food inflation rate for FY25 (April-December) was 4.3 per cent, which is 4.1 per cent lower than the overall food inflation.**
 - Similarly, the average headline inflation would be 3.2 per cent when the vegetables and pulses inflation rate were excluded, 1.7 per cent lower than the actual headline inflation.
 - **Thus, Vegetables and Pulses drove food inflation in India in the last two years. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- Uneven monsoon-induced supply disruptions in certain regions caused price pressures, mainly in tomatoes and onions, contributing to higher inflation rates in vegetables and overall food inflation.

Q 14.A

- As per the Union Budget 2025-26, the major contributors to total tax revenue (in increasing order) are:
 - **Customs Duty (Lowest)** – Contributes the least among the four due to trade liberalization and reductions in import duties to promote global trade.

- **Corporate Tax** – Has been increasing in recent years but remains lower than GST and Personal Income Tax.
- **Goods and Services Tax (GST)** – One of the largest indirect tax contributors, collected from businesses and consumers.
- **Personal Income Tax (Highest)** – The largest contributor to tax revenue.



Q 15.B

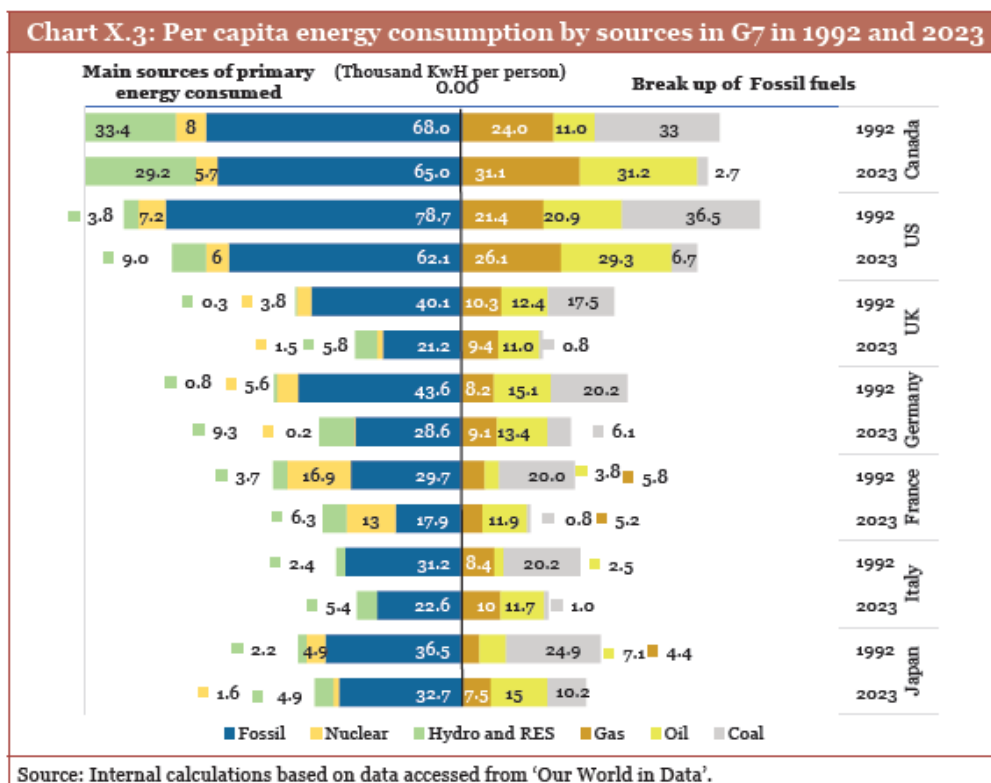
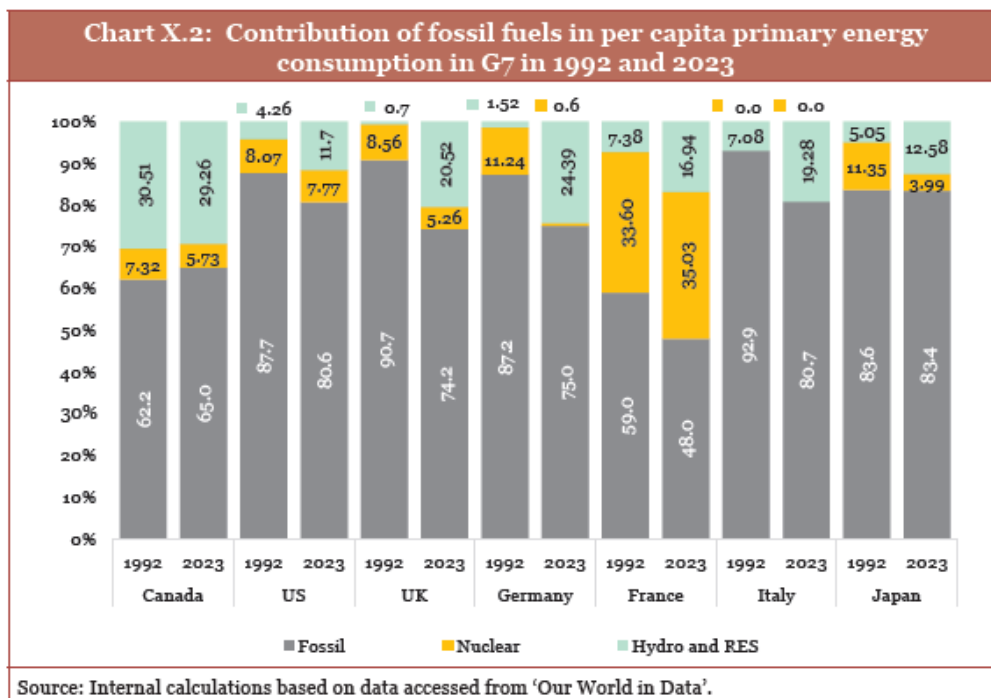
- The Economy Survey 2024-25 highlights the integration of the global economy since the 1980s as a part of globalization.
- In 1980, global trade accounted for about 39 percent of world GDP. By 2012, this share had risen to 60 per cent. The global trade-to-GDP ratio has increased from 39% to 60%, but it has not doubled since 1980. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- Global FDI inflows grew from USD 54 billion in 1980 to over USD 1.5 trillion in 2019, showcasing the increasing role of multinational corporations in cross-border investments. Therefore, FDI flow has almost tripled since 1980. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The global economy grew from USD 11 trillion in 1980 to over USD 100 trillion in 2022 (nominal). **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Extreme poverty rates (those living on less than USD 2.15 a day) fell from 42 per cent of the global population in 1981 to 8.4 per cent in 2019, driven by rapid economic growth in countries like China and India. **Hence, statement 4 is not correct.**
- In 1980, internet connectivity was virtually non-existent. By 2022, over 5.3 billion people, or 66 per cent of the global population, had access to the internet.
- The global population grew from 4.4 billion in 1980 to 8 billion in 2022, with urbanisation rates rising from 39 per cent in 1980 to 57 per cent in 2022.

Q 16.B

- **Recent context: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation exploring relevance of Copenhagen Framework on Citizen Data and its integration with India's statistical system.**
- **About the Framework**
 - Need: Citizen data, encompassing citizen-generated data, community-driven data, and citizen science data, typically fall outside of official statistics despite being part of the national data ecosystem.
 - Genesis: Developed by UN Statistics Division (UNSD) in 2023.
- **Key provisions:**
 - Defines the possible types of citizen data and offers a common understanding of relevant concepts and their definitions as a solid foundation for citizen data.
 - Provides a scope that helps conceptualize and agree on the different ways citizens can play a role in data.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 17.A

- Recent data about the G7 countries (Charts 2 and 3) for almost the last six decades (1992 to 2023) shows that these countries continue to rely heavily on fossil fuels in their per capita primary energy consumption, shifting from coal and oil-based energy to gas-based energy. The friction between energy transition and energy security is clearly evident in the actions of developed countries, revealing the limitations of transitioning to renewable energy sources such as wind and solar. First is the significant ‘congestion cost’ of managing a complex energy system incorporating fossil fuels and renewables. **With the shift to renewable energy, there has also been an increasing trend in electricity prices. The congestion and higher cost have led to instances of wind turbines being curtailed due to grid limitations, necessitating the activation of gas plants to meet peak demand. The shift from coal to natural gas as the base load has been the policy choice for ensuring grid stability in the UK and other developed countries. Developed countries have utilised their most abundant fuel in their transition. The transition to renewable energy has been tardy, forcing a return to fossil fuels to ensure stable supply and address rising electricity prices. Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**



Q 18.D

- The Gyan Bharatam Mission is aimed at the survey, documentation, and conservation of India's rich manuscript heritage, covering over one crore manuscripts.
- It will also establish a National Digital Repository of Indian Knowledge Systems to preserve and share India's traditional knowledge.
- **Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 19.D

- According to the 2024 **Annual Review by the International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA)**, the total number of jobs in the renewable energy sector in India reached an estimated 1.02 million in 2023. **Hydropower (44%) is the largest employer in India's renewable sector**, providing approximately 453,000 jobs and accounting for 20 per cent of the global total, ranking second only to China.
- **Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 20.D

- **The eShram portal, was launched by the Ministry of Labour and Employment (MoLE) on 26 August 2021 to recognise unorganised workers (not organised).** The portal helps register and support unorganised workers by providing them with a Universal Account Number (UAN) and for the creation of a comprehensive National Database of Unorganised Workers (NDUW). As of 31 December 2024, **over 30.51 crore unorganised workers have already registered on the eShram portal. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- Further, in keeping with the vision of developing eShram as a One-Stop-Solution for unorganised labour to have access to various social sector schemes, MoLE launched the eShram– “One-Stop-Solution” on 21 October 2024, which entails the integration of different social security/ welfare schemes on a single portal, i.e., eShram. This enables unorganised workers registered on eShram to access social security schemes and see benefits availed by them so far through eShram. **So far, 12 schemes of different central ministries/departments have already been integrated/ mapped with the eShram.** These include Pradhan Mantri Surakhsha Bima Yojana, Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana, Ayushman Bharat - Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana, Prime Minister Street Vendors AatmaNirbhar Nidhi, PM Awas Yojana- Urban, PM Awas Yojana- Gramin, Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme etc. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 21.C

- The Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) results for the FY23 highlight indicate a continued increase in the number of large factories i.e., those employing more than 100 workers. The number of such factories saw a robust growth of 7 per cent compared to FY22, while small factories (employing fewer than 100 workers) also experienced a steady increase of 2 per cent. Notably, **large factories now account for around 22 per cent of all operational factories**, reflecting their growing presence and contribution to the industrial landscape. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **In terms of the share of employment, large factories continue to employ about 80 per cent of the total workers** and 78 per cent of the TPE in the sector, whereas small factories, although larger in number, comprise a smaller share of employment in the sector. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Seven industry groups in the sector contribute to around 54 per cent of the total employment. These are food products, textiles, basic metals, wearing apparel, motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers, machinery and equipment N.E.C., and chemicals and chemical products.

Q 22.C

- **The Union Budget 2025-26 has set a target of 100 GW nuclear power capacity by 2047, and Small Modular Reactors (SMRs) are expected to contribute significantly to this goal.**
 - Nuclear Energy Mission for research & development of Small Modular Reactors (SMR) will be launched to operationalize at least 5 indigenously developed SMRs by 2033.
 - SMRs will help expand India's nuclear energy production while reducing dependence on fossil fuels.
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 23.A

- India has a total road network of 63.4 lakh km, including National highway (NH) network of 146,195 km. The NH comprises only 2 per cent of total road network yet it carries about 40 per cent of the overall road freight traffic. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- The total length of National Highways in India is 146,145 Km (approx. 2%), while the total length of State Highways is around 179,535 Km (approx. 3%). **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- The United States has the world's largest road network, stretching nearly 4.1 million miles or 6.6 million kilometres. Following the USA is India, with just under 4 million miles or 6.4 million kilometres of roads in 2024. China ranks third with 3.2 million miles. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 24.B

- **The e-commerce industry in India has experienced swift expansion over the past few years**, driven by various elements such as the rise of technology-powered advancements like online payments, localized delivery services, data-driven interactions with customers, and digital marketing.
- **However, by current market size, India's e-commerce market makes up a small fraction, about 1.5 percent of the global market, and it is projected to stay around 2 percent in the coming years.** **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- **Further, the GST regime offers the benefit of zero-rated supplies, and e-commerce exporters are eligible for GST refunds.** As per section 2(47) of the CGST Act, 2017, a supply is said to be exempt, when it attracts nil rate of duty or is specifically exempted by a notification or kept out of the purview of tax (i.e., a non-GST supply). **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- **Recognizing the relevance of e-commerce exports, the Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) 2023 has laid down provisions for fostering cross-border digital trade and promoting e-commerce and other emerging export channels.** These include the Niryat Bandhu scheme, financial assistance to e-commerce exporters under the Market Access Initiative (MAI) scheme, export, and packing credit, and e-commerce export hubs.
- **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 25.C

- The industrial sector comprises industries that relate to the production of finished goods from raw materials. The industrial sector is also known as the secondary sector. **It consists of four sub-sectors:**
 - **Mining and quarrying;**
 - **Electricity, gas, water supply and utilities;**
 - **Manufacturing and**
 - **Construction**
- **Logistics fall under the service sector or tertiary sector of the economy**, as it primarily involves the management of the flow of goods and services, which is considered a service activity rather than a production process.
- **Hence, option (c) is the correct.**

Q 26.B

- As per the revised classification of MSMEs, a medium enterprise is defined as one with:
 - Investment in plant and machinery: Between ₹50 crore and ₹250 crore.
 - Annual turnover: Up to ₹500 crore

Revision in classification criteria for MSMEs	₹ in Crore	Investment		Turnover	
		Current	Revised	Current	Revised
	Micro Enterprises	1	2.5	5	10
	Small Enterprises	10	25	50	100
	Medium Enterprises	50	125	250	500

- The range mentioned in the question (₹10 crore and ₹25 crore) does not cover the full definition. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) exports have witnessed a remarkable rise, increasing from ₹3.95 lakh crore in 2020-21 to ₹12.39 lakh crore in 2024-25, underscoring their critical role in boosting India's economy and strengthening global trade. The total number of exporting MSMEs in 2024-25 has also increased considerably from 52,849 in 2020-21 to 1,73,350 in 2024-25. **MSMEs demonstrated an exemplary growth trajectory, contributing 45.73% to exports in 2023-24, which increased to 45.79% by May 2024, highlighting their growing impact on India's trade performance.** **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 27.C

- The Self-employed definition describes a self-employed person as someone who earns his income by taking contracts with a business rather than working for a particular employer. They do not get consistent salaries or wages from a particular employer because they usually work for more than one employer.
- **The proportion of self-employed workers in the workforce has risen from 52.2 per cent in 2017-18 to 58.4 per cent in 2023-24.** This shift reflects growing entrepreneurial activity and a preference for flexible work arrangements. **Hence statement 1 and statement 2 are not correct.**
- **Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 28.A

- The growth in the service sector, as measured by YoY change in the real GVA by services, has been above six per cent in each year in the last decade, except for the Covid-19 pandemic that affected FY21.
- **Information and computer related services had the maximum buoyancy among the services during the last decade (FY13 to FY23)** which grew at a trend rate of 12.8 per cent during the last decade and stepped up its share in overall GVA from 6.3 per cent in FY13 to 10.9 per cent in FY23. This service has shown outstanding resilience both during and after the pandemic.
- **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 29.D

- Among the other cleaner sources of energy, nuclear, being an efficient source of energy, has increasingly emerged as a reliable alternative to fossil fuel. However, there are challenges. The expansion of the use of nuclear power has to contend with public concerns about safety and the uncertainty that the latest technologies are controlled by a few countries. The Geographical concentration (Economic Survey, 2022-2023; 2023-2024) of uranium and other essential minerals also poses a challenge. **Besides, nuclear energy relies heavily on the stability of fossil fuel supply chains to produce sulfuric acid for uranium extraction. Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**
- By 2040, estimates suggest that a shortfall of sulfuric acid supply could range from 100 million to 320 million tonnes, depending on the extent of efforts to reduce carbon emissions. Furthermore, even in the short run, actions by key players can pose a risk to the growth of the nuclear power sector. The significance of nuclear energy, given its higher efficiency and low greenhouse gas emissions, requires a forward-looking perspective to address potential challenges in advance, facilitating a smoother transition.

Q 30.C

- **India's services sector** has been the steadiest contributor to the gross value added (GVA) in the economy. **Its contribution to the total GVA at current prices has increased from 50.6 per cent in FY14 to about 55 per cent in FY25.** It also provides employment to approximately 30 per cent of the workforce. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The growth in the service sector, as measured by YoY change in the real GVA by services, has been above six per cent in each year in the last decade, except for the Covid-19 pandemic that affected FY21. The average services growth rate before the pre- pandemic year was eight per cent. **The average services growth in the post-pandemic year i.e. FY23 to FY25 has risen to 8.3 per cent. Hence, statement 2 is correct**

Q 31.A

- **In labor, reinstatement effect is the increase in labor demand and share due to technological innovation.** For a sufficiently demand-elastic market, the displacement effects historically have been counterbalanced by the 'reinstatement effect'. Demand for new products and services due to new technology in a market with unmet demand has created new, auxiliary tasks where labour has a competitive advantage. It has been stated that, 'such new tasks not only generate a positive productivity effect, but also a reinstatement effect – reinstating labour into a broader range of tasks and thus change the task content of production in favour of labour. This increases labour demand and labour share.'
- **The Displacement effect** can refer to the reduction in employment as automation replaces tasks .
- **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 32.A

- The Department of Economic Affairs in the Ministry of Finance prepares the budget.
 - The Union Budget is primarily prepared by the Department of Economic Affairs (DEA) under the Ministry of Finance.

- The Department of Revenue only deals with tax policies and administration but does not prepare the entire budget.
- The Finance Minister finalizes and presents the budget in Parliament. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **The Indian Constitution does not officially use the term "Budget." Instead, it refers to it as the Annual Financial Statement (AFS) under Article 112.**
 - While the word "Budget" is frequently used in government documents, it is not explicitly mentioned in the Constitution.
 - **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 33.C

- **Friendshoring refers to relocating supply chains to countries that share similar political or strategic interests, strengthening economic ties between friendly nations.**
- **Nearshoring refers to shifting supply chains to geographically closer countries to reduce transportation costs and improve supply chain resilience.**
- Both concepts became prominent after the pandemic, the US-China trade war, and the Russia-Ukraine conflict, as countries sought to reduce dependence on strategic rivals.
- **This is part of the larger trend of geoeconomic fragmentation highlighted in the Economic Survey 2024-25.**
- **Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 34.A

- **Demand elasticities can help gauge a sector's ability to raise employment because of productivity enhancements from automation.** To understand the potential for employment increases in India's services sector, Bessen (2019)'s theoretical model is replicated with the help of data from RBI's KLEMS database. The data studied is for the period of 1994 to 2023.
- A sectoral comparison of estimates reveals that demand elasticities are high for sectors such as financial services, trade services, health and social work and business services.
- **The high elasticity in financial services could be indicative that the sector is yet to reach a stage of market saturation.** Productivity enhancement may therefore prove employment generating for the financial sector. Research also corroborates that information technology improvements tend to raise employment in finance, retail and wholesale industries. **High elasticities in the health and social work industry shows that automation can aid productivity and employment gains in this sector. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Interestingly, post and telecom also show **low elasticity**. This sector in particular has reached a high degree of market saturation over the past three decades. The oligopolistic nature of the industry may also imply that **increases in labour productivity may come with lower costs which would translate to higher profit margins** (and not necessarily lower prices). A high degree of market saturation and oligopolist market structure imply that prices may not reflect declining costs. Automation may therefore behave as a labour-displacing force than a labour augmenting one. **Hence, statement 2 and statement 3 are not correct.**

Q 35.B

- **A Composite Index of Agricultural Sustainability was calculated by the Indian Council of Agriculture Research using 51 indicators related to environmental health, soil and water quality, and socioeconomic development.** The average estimated value of the Index is 0.49, suggesting that Indian agriculture is moderately sustainable. States like Mizoram, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Manipur, West Bengal, and Uttarakhand perform better than the national average. In contrast, arid Rajasthan has the least sustainable agricultural practices. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The states with higher sustainability scores have experienced sizable crop diversification, improvement in agriculture infrastructure, farm credit, and sustainable input usage. States in the Indo-Gangetic Plains, including Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Bihar, and Haryana, as well as rice-dominant states like Jharkhand and Assam, are at a higher risk of climate change impacts. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Q 36.A

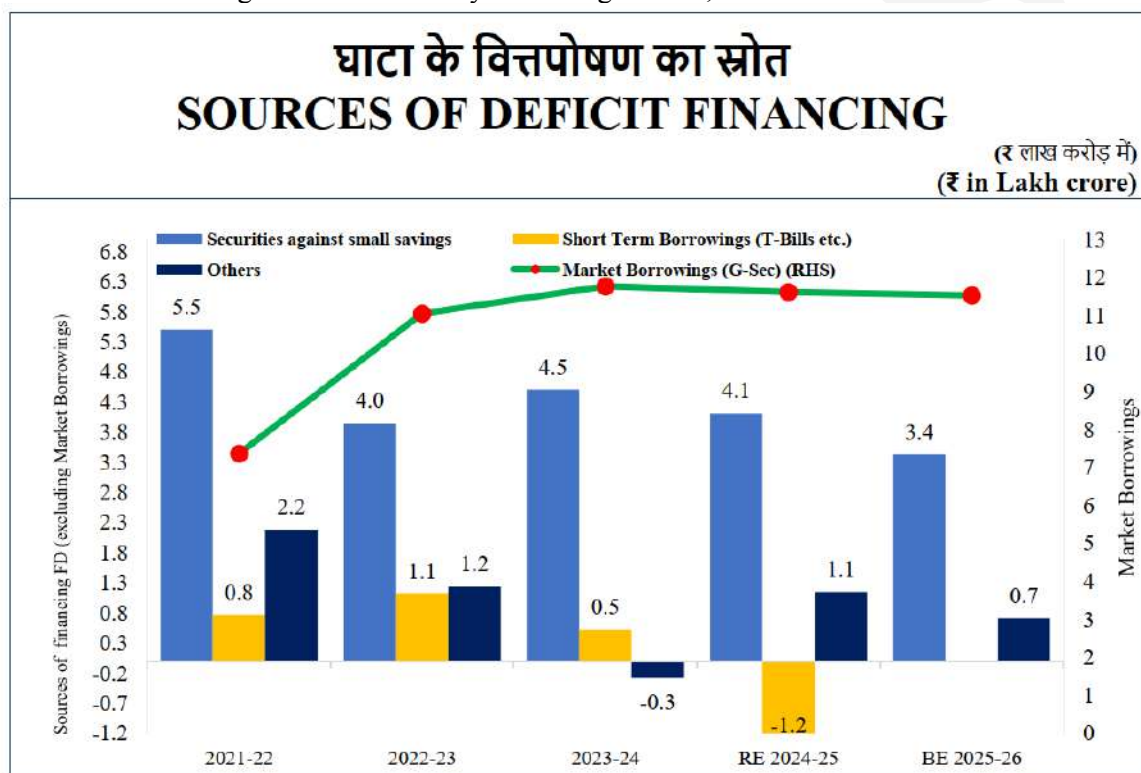
- Several studies have also assessed the overall effect of climate change on agricultural production. Negi and Ramaswami (2024) 21 examined the relationship between crop yields and rainfall across India at the district level for nine key crops during the kharif season. They found a strong link between significant rainfall shortfalls and substantial crop yield losses. This statistical phenomenon is known as **lower tail**

dependence, indicating that the correlation between yield losses and rainfall is stronger for extreme rainfall deficiencies than for minor variations.

- Hence option (a) is the correct answer.

Q 37.A

- As seen in the image, securities against small savings have consistently been a major component of deficit financing. In BE 2025-26, RE 2024-25, and previous years, it remains a significant share, often larger than other sources like short-term borrowings or "Others." **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The image clearly shows that short-term borrowings (T-Bills, represented in yellow) have not shown a steady increase.
 - In 2021-22, short-term borrowings were 0.8 lakh crore.
 - In 2022-23, they increased to 1.1 lakh crore.
 - In 2023-24, they fell to 0.5 lakh crore.
 - In RE 2024-25, they turned negative (-1.2 lakh crore), indicating repayment rather than new borrowing.
 - The trend is fluctuating rather than steadily increasing. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**



टिप्पणियाँ:- 1. अन्य में राज्य भविष्य निधि, विदेशी ऋण, नकद शेष में आहरण द्वारा कमी और अन्य प्राप्तियाँ शामिल हैं।

2. बजट अनुमान 2025-26 में टी बिल के माध्यम से निवल उधार शून्य है।

Notes:- 1. Others include State Provident Fund, External Debt, Drawdown of cash balance and other receipts.
2. Net borrowing through T-Bill is zero in BE 2025-26.

Q 38.D

- The government has been striving to achieve the objectives of National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 through a range of programmes and schemes, including the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan (along with its sub-schemes such as NISHTHA, Vidya Pravesh, District Institutes of Education and Training (DIETs), Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalaya (KGBV), etc.), DIKSHA, STARS, PARAKH, PM SHRI, ULLAS, and PM POSHAN, among others.
 - DIKSHA: Digital platform for teachers and students to access quality learning materials.
 - STARS (Strengthening Teaching-Learning and Results for States): Aims to improve the quality of education and governance in schools.
 - PARAKH (Performance Assessment, Review, and Analysis of Knowledge for Holistic Development): A national assessment center to reform student evaluation and align with NEP.
 - PM SHRI (Prime Minister Schools for Rising India): Aims to develop model schools showcasing NEP-aligned practices.
 - ULLAS (Understanding Lifelong Learning for All in Society): Focuses on adult education and foundational literacy, a core NEP goal.

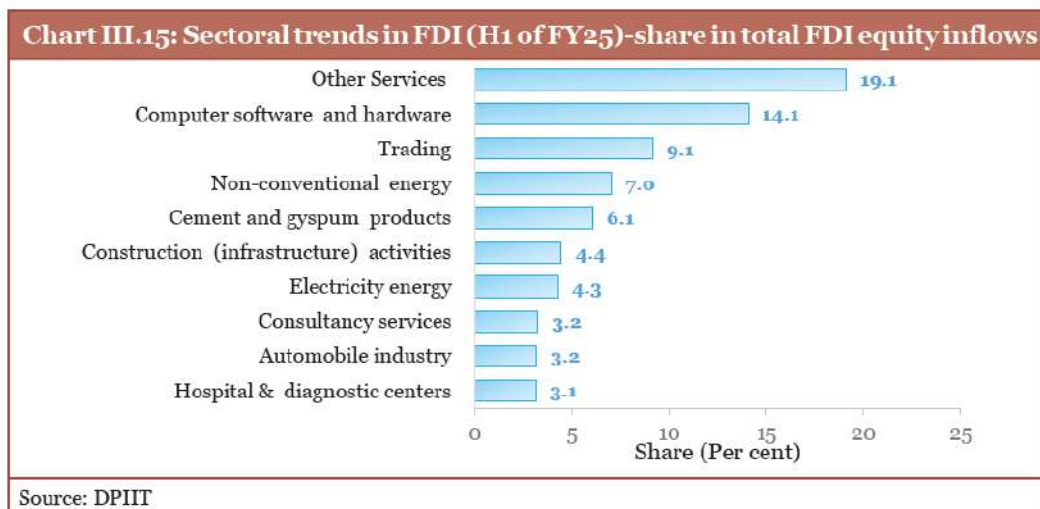
- PM POSHAN: Provides mid-day meals to improve student nutrition and attendance, indirectly supporting learning outcomes and equity — key elements of NEP. **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 39.D

- As per the Economic Survey 2024-25, persistent inflation in onions remained during FY24 and FY25, even as the government attempted to stabilize prices.
 - **The major cause of the high price is lower production during 2022-23 and 2023-24, which created a supply-demand gap. Storage also has an important role to play, as Rabi onions dictate the trend in inflation over time.**
- In contrast to onions, tomato price pressures have been episodic in FY23, i.e., prices change very often instead of consistently increasing.
 - More volatile than onions, with very frequent price hikes because of perishability and regional concentration.
 - Limited storage life constrains supply stability, hence very sensitive to shocks in prices.
- **Structural Reasons for Inflation in Both Crops:**
 - **Seasonality in production (Rabi dominance) results in fluctuations in supply.**
 - **Perishability (particularly in tomatoes) prevents storage, which results in price hikes.**
 - **The concentration of production in a region enhances exposure to localized shocks.**
- **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**

Q 40.B

- Over the long term, **FDI inflows into India have surpassed the USD 1 trillion mark from April 2000 to September 2024, solidifying the country's position as a safe and significant global investment destination.** According to data from the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), the cumulative FDI inflows, which include equity inflows, reinvested earnings, and other capital, reached USD 1,033.4 billion during this period.
- **From a sectoral perspective, the services sector remains the largest recipient of FDI, accounting for 19.1 percent of total equity inflows in H1 of FY25.** The Services sector includes Financial, Banking, Insurance, Non-Financial / Business, Outsourcing, R&D, Courier, and Tech. Testing and Analysis, etc. **Other significant sectors attracting foreign investments include computer software and hardware (14.1 percent), trading (9.1 percent), non-conventional energy (7 percent), and cement & gypsum products (6.1 percent). The share of the automobile sector is 3.2 percent.**



- **Hence, option(b) is the correct answer.**

Q 41.D

- To **improve food grain storage**, especially in hilly and remote areas, the government is exploring using **Flospan, a type of mobile storage unit (MSU)**, in collaboration with the World Food Programme (WFP). These units can be quickly erected and have a storage capacity of 400 metric tonnes. As a pilot project, WFP has installed Flospan in six states. **Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The **food processing industry in India is one of the largest employers within organized manufacturing**, accounting for 12.41 percent of total employment in the organized sector. In the fiscal year FY24, agri-food exports, including processed food exports, reached USD 46.44 billion, constituting

roughly 11.7 percent of India's total exports. Notably, the **share of processed food exports within agri-food exports has risen from 14.9 percent in FY18 to 23.4 percent in FY24. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

- The **Production Linked Incentive Scheme for Food Processing (PLISFPI), launched in 2021**, seeks to cultivate globally competitive food processing leaders by facilitating branding and marketing initiatives in international markets. By 31 October 2024, 171 applications had been approved under this scheme, with beneficiaries investing ₹8,910 crore and receiving ₹1,084.01 crore in incentives. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 42.B

- **Industrial Outlook Survey is released by RBI.**
 - It assesses business expectations in the manufacturing sector, covering demand conditions, production, employment, and capacity utilization.
 - The survey assesses business sentiment for the current quarter and expectations for the next quarter
- **Rural Economic Conditions and Sentiments Survey is conducted by the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD).**
 - It evaluates rural demand, household consumption, and overall economic sentiment in rural India.
- **Financial Stability Report is released by RBI.**
 - The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) publishes the Financial Stability Report (FSR) twice a year to analyze the health of India's financial system.
 - The FSR is prepared on behalf of the Financial Stability and Development Council (FSDC).
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 43.D

- Unemployment Rate (UR) is defined as the percentage of unemployed persons in the labour force.
- The 2023-24 annual Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) report by the National Statistical Organisation (NSO) highlights a significant post-pandemic recovery in employment trends across India. The **all-India annual unemployment rate (UR)** for individuals aged 15 years and above (**usual status**) has steadily declined from 6 per cent in 2017-18 to **3.2 per cent in 2023-24. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- For a person to be categorised as employed as per usual status (ps+ss), he/she must have pursued an economic activity for at least 30 days during the 365 days preceding the date of the survey. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- In the case of **Current Weekly Status (CWS)**, the activity status is determined on the basis of a **reference period of the last 7 days preceding the date of the survey.**

Q 44.D

- The power sector network continues to expand, with installed capacity rising by 7.2 per cent year-on-year to 456.7 GW as of November 2024.
- The installed capacity of renewable energy is 209.4 GW as of December 2024. Out of this, solar has 97.8GW, Hydro has 52.1 GW, wind has 48.2 GW, and Bioenergy has 11.3 GW of share. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The share of non-fossil fuel energy in the total installed energy capacity has increased from 38.6 GW (in FY21) to 47.1 GW (FY25 up to December). Further, its share has been steadily increasing since FY21. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The daily average power supply has improved from 22.1 hours in FY14 to 23.4 hours in FY24 in the urban areas and from 12.5 hours in FY14 to 21.9 hours in the rural areas. The gap between energy demand and supply has also declined from 4.2 percent in FY14 to a mere 0.1 percent by December 2024. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 45.B

- Unemployment rate (UR) is defined as the percentage of unemployed persons in the labour force.
- For a person to be categorised as employed as per usual status (ps+ss), he/she must have pursued an economic activity for at least 30 days during the 365 days preceding the date of the survey.
- **Trend in UR (usual status)**
 - 2019-20 - 4.8
 - 2020-21 - 4.2
 - 2021-22 - 4.1
 - **2022-23 - 3.2**

- **2023-24 - 3.2 Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- In the case of Current Weekly Status (CWS), the activity status is determined on the basis of a reference period of the last 7 days preceding the date of the survey.
- **Trend in UR (Current Weekly Status)**
- 2019-20 - 8.8
- 2020-21 - 7.5
- 2021-22 - 6.6
- 2022-23 - 5.1
- 2023-24 - 4.9 **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 46.D

- **India is the seventh most vulnerable country to climate change.** It suffers from weather extremes and hazards, slow onset events such as sea-level rise, biodiversity loss, and water insecurity. While greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions are a global bad and the benefits of mitigation are diffused, vulnerable developing countries such as India have to bear a disproportionate burden of climate change and have no choice but to face the consequence of historical emissions. The emissions remain with us. They impose huge costs on already resource-constrained countries. Hence, vulnerable developing countries such as India need to undertake climate adaptation on an urgent footing as this has a direct impact on lives, livelihoods and the economy. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- India's ambition to achieve developed nation status by 2047 is fundamentally anchored in the vision of inclusive and sustainable development. Notably, **India's per capita carbon emissions are one-third of the global average**, even as it stands among the world's fastest-growing economies. The country is dedicated to identifying and exploring pathways for low-carbon development that simultaneously ensure affordable energy security, job creation, economic growth, and environmental sustainability. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- A strong adaptation strategy is a priority for the country, given its significant vulnerability to climate change, stemming from its geographic and agro-climatic diversity. **India's Initial Adaptation Communication, submitted to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) in December 2023, reveals that the total expenditure related to adaptation in FY22 was 5.6 per cent of the Gross Domestic Product (GDP), an increase from 3.7 per cent in FY16. Climate action, so far, has been financed through domestic resources, with the public sector playing a central role.** On the other hand, the international flow of funds for climate actions is highly inadequate and has a mitigation bias. **Hence statements 3 and 4 are correct.**

Q 47.C

- The general government's social sector expenditure has been keeping pace with the sector's growing importance. The general government's social services expenditure (SSE) has shown a rising trend since FY17. The SSE as a percentage of total expenditure (TE) has increased from 23.3 percent in FY21 to 26.2 percent in FY25 (BE). The social services expenditure witnessed an increase of 21 percent in FY24 (RE) over FY23 and another 10 percent increase in FY25 (BE) over FY24 (RE).
- **During the five years from FY21 (pandemic year) to FY25 (BE), the SSE grew at a CAGR of 15 per cent.** While the SSE outlay of the centre and state governments was ₹14.8 lakh crore in FY21, it has increased steadily to stand at ₹25.7 lakh crore in FY25 (BE). **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Expenditure on education has grown at a CAGR of 12 per cent** from ₹ 5.8 lakh crore in FY21 to ₹ 9.2 lakh crore in FY25 (BE). **Expenditure on health grew at a CAGR of 18 percent** from ₹ 3.2 lakh crore in FY21 to ₹ 6.1 lakh crore in FY25 (BE). **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- The Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES) 2023-24 results highlight **the narrowing urban-rural gap in consumption expenditure.**
 - The average monthly per capita expenditure (MPCE) in rural and urban India in 2023-24 is estimated at ₹4,122 and ₹6,996, respectively. Considering the imputed values of items received free of cost through various social welfare programmes, these estimates rise to ₹4,247 and ₹7,078, respectively, for rural and urban areas. The urban-rural gap in MPCE has declined to 71 per cent in 2022-23 from 84 percent in 2011-12. **It has further come down to 70 per cent in 2023-24**, which confirms the sustained momentum of consumption growth in rural areas.

Q 48.B

- **The Reverse Charge Mechanism (RCM) is the process of GST Payment by the receiver instead of the supplier.** In this case, the liability of tax payment is transferred to the recipient/receiver instead of the supplier. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- **The Reverse Charge Mechanism is applicable in the case of :**
- Imports
- **Purchase from an unregistered dealer. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Supply of notified goods and services
- RCM GST payments should be made keeping the following points in mind:
- ITC on RCM tax amounts can only be claimed by recipients of goods or services if they are used to conduct business or further that business. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- If a composition dealer discharges liability under RCM, he should pay tax at the normal rates, not the composition rates. Additionally, they are not eligible to claim GST credit.
- RCM tax payables or charges can be subject to GST compensation cess.

Q 49.A

- **India has successfully established an installed electricity generation capacity of 213,701 megawatts from non-fossil fuel sources, which accounts for 46.8 per cent of the total capacity as of 30 November 2024. The goal is to reach 50 per cent by 2030. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- The **National Bioenergy Programme** is structured around three main pillars:
 - the Waste to Energy Programme, the Biomass Programme, **which supports the manufacturing of briquettes and pellets** as well as promotes biomass (**non-bagasse**) based cogeneration in industries, and the Biogas Programme, which focuses on promoting family-type biogas plants. **Hence statement 3 is not correct.**
 - As of 31 December 2024, the installed capacity for biomass power and cogeneration projects stood at approximately 9.8 gigawatts (gridconnected) and 0.92-gigawatt equivalent (off-grid), while waste-to-energy projects reached a capacity of 249.74 megawatts (grid-connected) and 370.19-megawatt equivalent (as on 9 January 2025) (off-grid). Under the biogas programme, around 5.1 million small biogas plants and 361 medium-sized biogas plants (totalling 11.5 megawatts) have been installed.
- **The projects under the Green Energy Corridor (GEC) aim to establish an intra-state transmission system that enhances grid capabilities for renewable energy.** Currently, GEC-I is being implemented across eight states, successfully installing 9,136 circuit kilometres of transmission lines and 21,413 megavolt-amperes (MVA) substations. Meanwhile, GEC-II is progressing across seven additional states. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**
- **The National Green Hydrogen Mission aims to achieve a production capacity of about five million metric tonnes per annum of Green Hydrogen,** along with an associated renewable energy capacity of around 125 gigawatts and the potential for 50 million metric tonnes of CO₂ annual emission abatement by 2030. The mission also focuses on bolstering research and development, as well as standards and testing within the green hydrogen ecosystem. Under the mission, the green hydrogen production capacity of 412,000 tonnes per annum and electrolyser manufacturing capacity of 3000 megawatts per annum have been successfully awarded.

Q 50.D

- India's labour regulations impose extensive compliance requirements on businesses. In doing so, it dampens employment generation as well. Some such examples are presented here:
- **Inflexible working hours**
 - Section 51 of the Factories Act (1948) states, '**No adult worker shall be required or allowed to work in a factory for more than forty-eight hours in any week.**' This clause limits the number of hours a worker can work in a day and a week. However, unlike India, certain countries allow these caps to be averaged over multiple days and weeks. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Restrictions on overtime for factory workers**
 - Section 65(3)(iv) of the Factories Act (1948) states, '**No worker shall be allowed to work overtime for more than seven consecutive days, and the total number of overtime hours in any quarter shall not exceed seventy-five.**' This law limits the number of overtime hour workers can perform and the overtime wages they can earn. The earning potential of workers across countries can be assessed based on the restrictions on overtime hours. **Hence, statement 2 and 3 are correct.**

Q 51.B

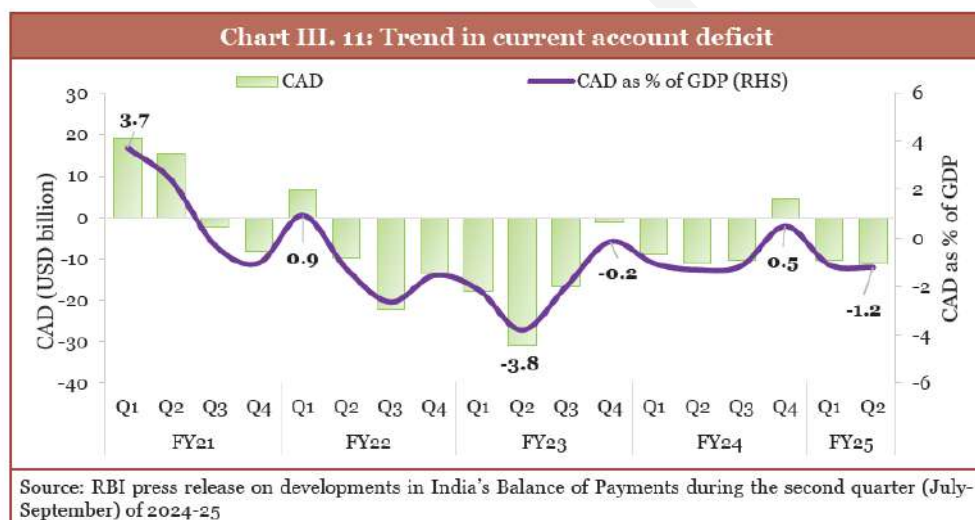
- The GOI launched Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0 in 2021, which aims to create 'garbage-free cities.' To encourage cities to improve urban sanitation, the government developed the ODF, ODF+, ODF ++, and Water+ protocols to evaluate urban local bodies (ULBs) on standardised parameters of sustainable sanitation.

- Open Defecation Free (ODF) certified: Complete access to toilets by citizens and ensuring that nobody goes out for open defecation at any time of day or night. **Hence, pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- ODF+: **ODF and all community and public toilets are clean, hygienic, and functional while following basic cleanliness criteria. Hence, pair 2 is not correctly matched.**
- ODF++: **ODF+ and complete faecal sludge from toilets is safely contained, transported, and treated while ensuring that no untreated sludge is discharged in the open. Hence, pair 3 is not correctly matched.**
- **Water+: ODF++ and ensuring that no untreated liquid waste (including wastewater) is discharged without proper treatment and ensuring maximum reuse of treated wastewater. Hence, pair 4 is correctly matched.**

Q 52.B

- The dependency ratio is the number of children (age 0-14 years) and older persons (age 60 years and above) per 100 (not lakh) working age population (15-59 years). The calculation of the ratio is given below: $\text{Dependency Ratio} = 100 \times (\text{Population (0-14)} + \text{Population (60+)}) / \text{Population (15-59)}$. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The **total dependency ratio** has declined from 64.6 per cent in 2011 to **55.7 per cent in 2021** and is projected to fall further to **54.3 per cent by 2026. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The declining dependency ratio, marked by the falling child dependency ratio following declining fertility rates, has contributed to this demographic advantage. This is further supported by a relatively gradual increase in the elderly dependency ratio due to increased life expectancy. **An increased life expectancy directly leads to a higher dependency ratio**, as a larger proportion of the population reaches older age and becomes dependent on the working-age population for support, creating a greater burden on the workforce to provide for retirees.

Q 53.D



- India witnessed a Current Account Surplus (CAS) in FY21, but the balance has returned to deficit in subsequent years. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- India's CAD, as a percentage of GDP, has shown a mixed trend over the past 5 years — widening post-pandemic, moderating slightly in recent quarters but not consistently declining. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 54.B

- The REPowerEU plan, introduced by the European Commission in response to the 2022 Russian invasion of Ukraine, aims to end the European Union's reliance on Russian fossil fuels before 2030. The plan focuses on three main objectives:
 - **Saving Energy:** Implementing measures to reduce energy consumption across member states.
 - **Diversifying Energy Supplies:** Seeking alternative energy sources to replace Russian imports, including increased imports of liquefied natural gas (LNG) and the development of renewable energy projects.
 - **Accelerating Clean Energy Production:** Promoting the rapid deployment of renewable energy sources such as wind, solar, and green hydrogen to transition towards a more sustainable energy system.

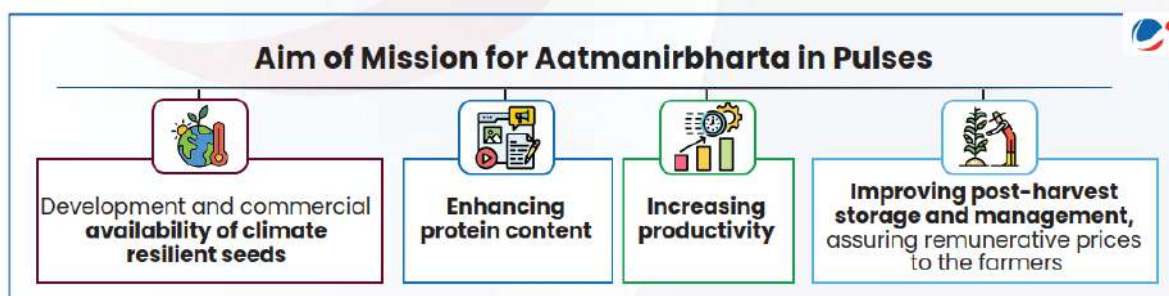
- These initiatives collectively aim to enhance the EU's energy security and support its climate goals by reducing dependence on Russian fossil fuels and fostering a transition to clean energy.
- **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 55.A

- **Technical textiles** are specialized textile materials designed for specific functions rather than appearance. **They are manufactured using natural fibers (such as cotton, wool, silk) as well as man-made fibres (like polyester, nylon). Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
 - They are designed to have high levels of physical, mechanical, thermal, and/or chemical properties for use in specific applications within industrial sectors such as earthworks, construction, civil engineering, transport, defense, medical, and healthcare.
- Technical textiles are another area of potential growth. **India's technical textile industry is rapidly growing, ranking fifth globally. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Indian technical textiles market stands at US\$26.8 billion in FY2415. **India is a net exporter of technical textiles, with exports valuing US\$2.58 billion in FY24. Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
 - To assist the technical textiles manufacturing ecosystem, the government has introduced several initiatives, including the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme. To ensure quality and standardisation of the technical textiles, 68 items have been brought under regulation through quality control order in various segments.

Q 56.B

- The Aatmanirbharta in Pulses Mission is a six-year initiative launched in the Union Budget 2025-26. It focuses on boosting the production of Tur, Urad, and Masoor pulses. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**



- The mission includes efforts to develop climate-resilient seeds and enhance protein content in pulses. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The government has announced unlimited procurement of Tur, Urad, and Masoor pulses for four years through National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Ltd. (NAFED) and National Cooperative Consumers' Federation of India Limited (NCCF) benefiting registered farmers. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

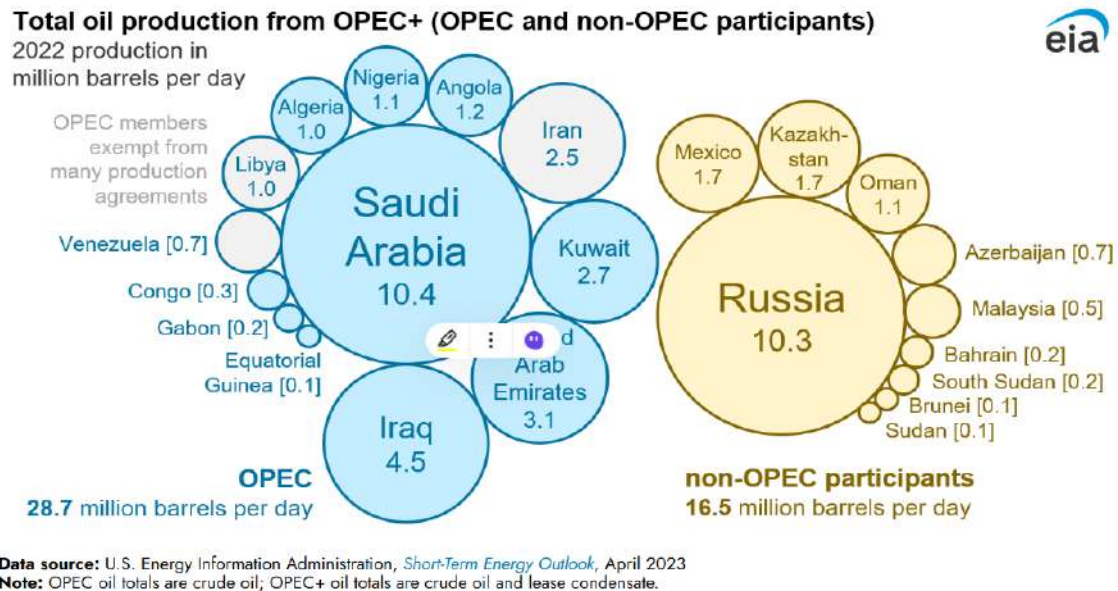
Q 57.C

- **The Commodity Markets Outlook is a key report published by the World Bank, providing insights into global trends in commodity prices, supply-demand dynamics, and economic impacts.**
- The report is released twice a year (typically in April and October) and covers sectors like energy, metals, agriculture, and fertilizers.
- As per World Bank's Commodity Markets Outlook¹², October 2024, commodity prices are expected to decrease by 5.1 per cent in 2025 and 1.7 per cent in 2026.
 - The projected declines are led by oil prices but tempered by price increases for natural gas and a stable outlook for metals and agricultural raw materials.
 - Among precious metals, gold prices are expected to decrease while silver prices are expected to increase.
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 58.C

- **Recent Context: Recently, Brazil approved entry into OPEC+.**
- **The Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries, also known as OPEC, was formed in 1960 by Iraq, Iran, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia, and Venezuela. The organization has since expanded to 13 members.** OPEC regularly meets to set oil production targets and coordinate output to help manage global oil prices for the entire group.

- In 2016, largely in response to dramatically falling oil prices driven by significant increases in U.S. shale oil output, **OPEC signed an agreement with 10 other oil-producing countries to create what is now known as OPEC+.** Among these 10 countries was the world's third-largest oil producer in 2022, **Russia, which produced 13% of the world's total (10.3 million barrels per day).** Thus **OPEC+ alliance includes major non-OPEC oil producers such as Russia, South Sudan, and Brunei.**
- OPEC's stated objective is to "co-ordinate and unify petroleum policies among Member Countries" to secure pricing for producers, supply for consumers, and return on capital for investors, although the group is best known for its effect on global crude oil prices.



- Hence option (c) is the correct answer.

Q 59.D

- The Ministry of Women and Child Development (MWCD) has released the National Curriculum for Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) 2024 titled 'Aadharshila'. **Hence option (d) is the correct answer.**
 - It is a detailed 48-week curriculum meant for learning in the age-group of three to six-year-olds in anganwadis.
 - It is aligned with the National Education Policy 2020.
 - It will serve as a base for States to develop their own culturally appropriate curriculums.

Q 60.B

- **Consumer Food Price Index (CFPI) is a statistical indicator that measures changes in the retail prices of food consumed by a given population group. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- It is a component of the overall Consumer Price Index (CPI) and specifically measures food inflation.
- **Important Features of CFPI:**
 - **The CFPI is computed on a monthly basis by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MOSPI), Central Statistics Office (CSO), for rural, urban, and combined for India. Hence statement 2 is correct.**
 - CFPI base year is 2012, previously changed from 2010 in January 2015.
 - The CFPI comprises a number of subgroups like cereals and products, pulses and products, oils and fats, eggs, fish and meat, milk and products, condiments and spices, vegetables, fruits, sugar, etc. Weights to be given to the subgroups differ marginally in rural, urban, and combined categories.
 - The methodology used in calculating CFPI is just the same as the CPI with price data collection done from a number of chosen towns and villages.
 - CFPI is utilized to track food inflation, guide monetary policy, and observe poverty levels. It assists in setting thresholds for social protection initiatives.

Q 61.C

- The results of the Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES) 2023- 24 highlight the narrowing urban-rural gap in consumption expenditure. The average monthly per capita expenditure (MPCE) in rural and urban India in 2023-24 is estimated at ₹4,122 and ₹6,996, respectively. Considering the imputed values of items received free of cost through various social welfare programmes, these estimates

rise to ₹4,247 and ₹7,078, respectively, for rural and urban areas. The urban-rural gap in MPCE has declined to 71 per cent in 2022-23 from 84 per cent in 2011-12. It has further come down to 70 per cent in 2023-24, which confirms the sustained momentum of consumption growth in rural areas.

- Social sector initiatives have reduced inequality and increased consumption spending, as reflected in the survey. The Gini coefficient improved for rural areas (declined to 0.237 in 2023-24 from 0.266 in 2022-23) and urban areas (declined to 0.284 in 2023-24 from 0.314 in 2022-23). The bottom 5 per cent of the rural population, ranked by MPCE, has an average MPCE of ₹1,677, compared to ₹2,376 in urban areas. The top 5 per cent have average MPCEs of ₹10,137 in rural and ₹20,310 in urban areas.
- **Fiscal policies of the government are playing a key role in reshaping income distribution, inter alia, through the provision of subsidies, pensions, and other direct transfers, as well as public spending on social services such as education and health.** Various government welfare schemes such as free foodgrain or subsidised availability of foodgrains, subsidised cooking fuel, insurance cover, etc, are lifting household incomes. These fiscal transfers help to provide additional resources to the financially deprived sections and, thus, favourably impact people's standard of living. As an example, building upon the learnings of the HCES, a study by the World Bank presents evidence of the re-distribution impact of the Public Distribution System (PDS). **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 62.C

- A review of preliminary unaudited estimates of 27 states for the period April - November 2024 shows Gross Tax Revenue of the union and own tax revenue (OTR) of the states have increased at comparable pace during this period.
- Among the state-specific taxes, stamps and registration, sales tax, state excise duties, and other taxes and duties registered positive growth, whereas land revenue declined, for states as a collective.
- **For 15 states, OTR accounted for more than half of their total tax receipts, the highest being Telangana at 88 percent, followed by Karnataka and Haryana at 86 percent each.**
- **Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 63.A

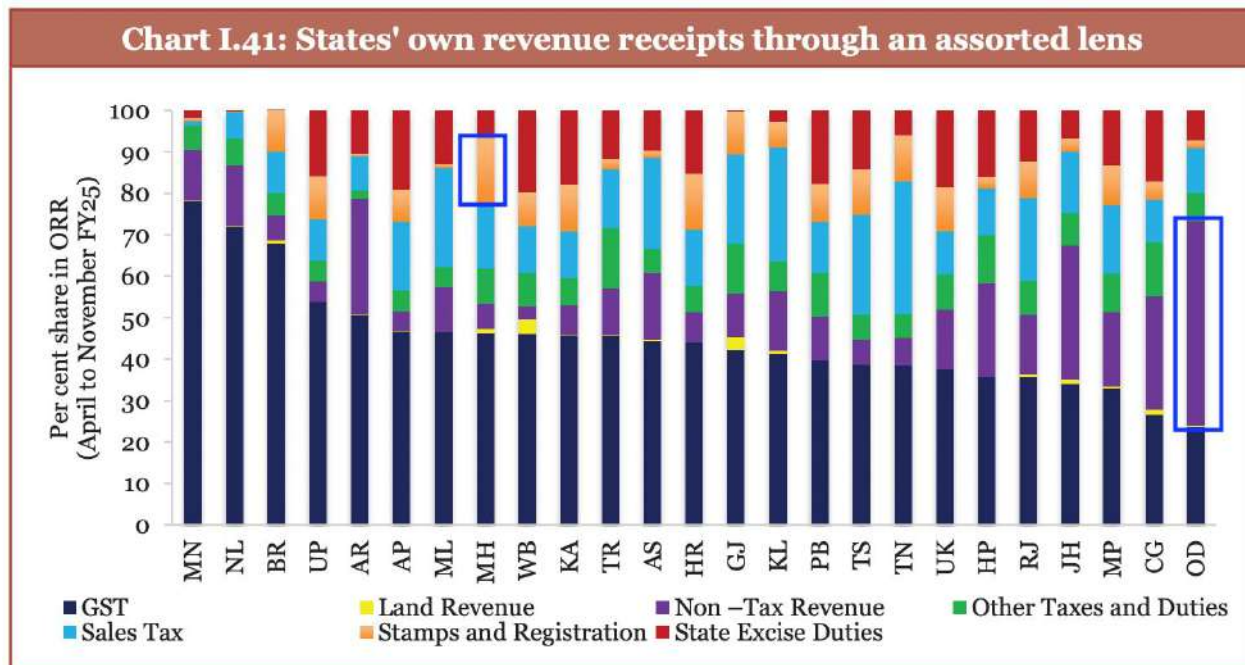
- **Recent Context: Recently, Sovereign Green Bonds (SGrBs) are seeing limited investor interest due to lower yields.**
- Sovereign Green Bonds (SGBs) are issued by the central government, not state governments. These bonds are a type of debt instrument used to raise funds exclusively for environmentally sustainable projects. State governments can issue State Development Loans (SDLs) for green projects, but SGBs are issued at the national level by the Government of India. **Hence statement (a) is correct and (d) is not correct.**
- Sovereign Green Bonds ensure that the funds raised are used only for projects that promote environmental sustainability. Eligible projects include renewable energy, clean transportation, energy efficiency, pollution prevention, and climate adaptation. Essentially, these bonds are a way for governments to raise capital while promoting environmental sustainability. **Hence statement (b) is not correct.**
- The Union Budget 2022-23 first announced the issuance of Sovereign Green Bonds as part of India's commitment to sustainable financing. In 2023-24, the government issued SGBs in tranches, and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) managed their issuance. **Hence statement (c) is not correct.**

Q 64.A

- **Recent Context: Wet testing (a critical submersion test) of the 4th Generation deep-ocean human scientific submersible 'Matsya-6000' successfully completed.**
- Deep Ocean Mission has been launched w.e.f. 07.09.2021, as a Central Sector Scheme of the Ministry of Earth Sciences with the approval of the Cabinet. Samudrayaan is a project under the Deep Ocean Mission. Under the Samudrayaan project of Deep Ocean Mission, MATSYA 6000 manned submersible design has been completed so far. **The mission is aimed at sending three personnel to a 6000-metre depth in a vehicle called 'MATSYA 6000' for the exploration of deep-sea resources like minerals.**
- 'MATSYA 6000' vehicle is being designed and developed by National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT), Chennai, under Ministry of Earth Science. It is designed with the capability of operating in the deep sea for 12 hours while in case of emergency, it can also operate up to 96 hours with all the necessary measures for human safety.
- Samudrayaan is India's first attempt at human deep-sea exploration and aims to place India among the few nations (like the US, Russia, China, Japan, and France) that have developed manned submersibles for deep-sea research.
- **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 65.A

- For 23 States, GST was the main source of revenue amongst own revenue receipts(ORR) with the greatest reliance thereon by Manipur and Nagaland at 78 percent and 72 percent, respectively. Hence statement 1 is not correct.
- States garnering the highest shares in respective ORRs w.r.t. stamps & registration, sales tax and state excise duties were Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu and West Bengal, respectively. Hence statement 3 is correct.
- Odisha exhibited the highest share of non-tax revenue in ORR at 49 percent. Hence statement 2 is not correct.



Q 66.A

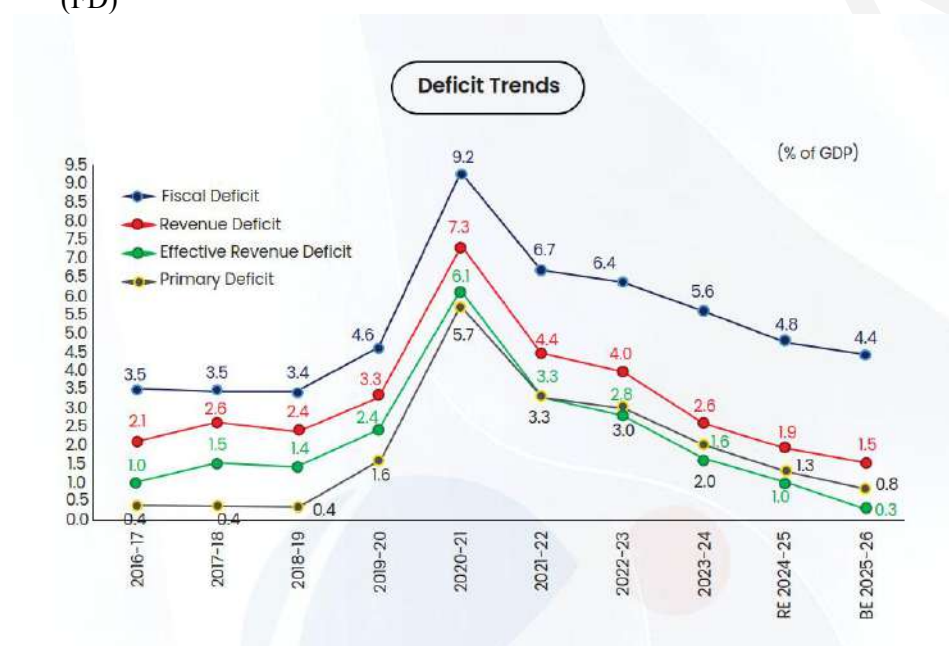
- In a significant move to support the agricultural sector and address rising input costs, the Reserve Bank of India has announced an increase in the limit for collateral-free agricultural loans, including loans for allied activities.
 - The existing loan limit of ₹1.6 lakh per borrower has been raised to ₹2 lakh.
- This decision acknowledges the impact of inflation and the increasing cost of agricultural inputs on farmers. It aims to provide enhanced financial access to farmers, ensuring they have sufficient resources to meet their operational and developmental needs without the burden of providing collateral.
- By streamlining loan disbursement, the initiative is expected to increase the uptake of Kisan Credit Card (KCC) loans, allowing farmers to invest in agricultural operations and improve their livelihoods.
- Combined with the Modified Interest Subvention Scheme, offering loans up to ₹3 lakh at a 4% effective interest rate, this policy strengthens financial inclusion, supports the agricultural sector, and fosters credit-driven economic growth, aligning with the government's long-term vision for sustainable agriculture.
- Hence option (a) is the correct answer.

Q 67.C

- The livestock sector has emerged as a significant engine of growth in agriculture, playing a vital role in the overall agricultural landscape. The economic significance of this sector is clearly illustrated by its escalating output value, which reached an astounding 17.25 lakh crore rupees (equivalent to US\$205.81 billion) in FY23. Among the various branches of livestock production, the milk industry generated the highest revenue, surpassing even paddy and wheat production, generating over ₹11.16 lakh crore (US\$133.16 billion) in revenue. Hence statement 1 is correct.
- The government has supported the livestock sector through various initiatives by recognizing the growing importance of the livestock sector and its potential to boost farm incomes. The mechanism of Multipurpose AI Technicians in Rural India (MAITRIs) has been established to deliver breeding inputs to farmers' at their doorstep. Under the scheme, MAITRIs are trained and equipped to deliver quality artificial insemination services to farmers' doorsteps. During the last 3 years, 38,736 MAITRIs have been trained and equipped under Rashtriya Gokul Mission. Hence statement 2 is correct.

Q 68.B

- **Effective Revenue Deficit (ERD) = Revenue Deficit - Grants for Capital Asset Creation**
 - It represents the portion of the revenue deficit that does not contribute to asset creation.
 - Since grants for capital creation are subtracted from the revenue deficit, the Effective Revenue Deficit (**0.3% of GDP**) is the lowest among the given deficits.
- **Primary Deficit (PD) = Fiscal Deficit - Interest Payments**
 - It indicates the government's borrowing requirement, excluding interest payments on past debt.
 - As per Budget 2025-26, the primary deficit (**0.8% of GDP**) is higher than the Effective Revenue Deficit and lower than the Revenue deficit.
- **Revenue Deficit (RD) = Revenue Expenditure - Revenue Receipts**
 - It shows the shortfall in revenue receipts compared to revenue expenditure, indicating how much of the government's revenue is borrowed for day-to-day expenses.
 - RD (**1.5% of GDP**) is higher than the Primary deficit but lower than the Fiscal Deficit.
- **Fiscal Deficit (FD) = Total Expenditure - Total Receipts (excluding borrowings)**
 - FD (**4.4% of GDP**) is the largest among all deficits, representing the total borrowing requirement of the government.
- Increasing order as a percentage of GDP:
 - Effective Revenue Deficit (ERD) < Primary Deficit (PD) < Revenue Deficit (RD) < Fiscal Deficit (FD)



- Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

Q 69.C

- According to the PLFS, **LFPR** is the percentage of working-age population engaged in work or making tangible efforts to seek 'work' or being available for 'work' if it is available. 'Work' includes self-employment (subsistence agriculture and collection of firewood, poultry farming, etc., for self-consumption), regular wage/salaried employment, and casual labour.
- **Trend in Labour force participation rate (LFPR)-usual status**
 - 2019-20 - 53.5
 - 2020-21 - 54.9
 - 2021-22 - 55.2
 - 2022-23 - 57.9
 - 2023-24 - 60.1 Hence, statement 1 is correct.
- **WPR** is defined as the percentage of employed persons in the total population.
- **Trend in Worker-to-Population ratio (WPR)-usual status**
 - 2019-20 - 50.9
 - 2020-21 - 52.6
 - 2021-22 - 52.9
 - 2022-23 - 56.0
 - 2023-24 - 58.2 Hence, statement 2 is correct.

Q 70.B

- The export of services grew at a trend rate of 11 per cent during FY14 to FY23, at constant prices. India's services export growth accelerated to 12.8 per cent in April-November FY25 from 5.7 per cent in FY24. In April-November FY25, services imports grew by 13.9 per cent, in contrast to a decline of 2.9 per cent during the same period in FY24.
- **Services exports as per cent of services GVA (net of public administration)**
- FY19 - 18.0
- FY20 - 17.0
- FY21 - 18.4
- FY22 - 19.0
- FY23 - 22.0
- **The trend was not consistently increasing, as there was a decline from 18.0% in FY19 to 17.0% in FY20 before rising again. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- **In FY23, services exports were 22.0% of services GVA (net of public administration), which is greater than 20%. Hence, and statement 2 is correct.**

Q 71.B

- **The Indian Pharmaceutical Industry is the world's third-largest by volume.** The industry boasts of a diverse product portfolio encompassing generic drugs, bulk drugs, over-the-counter medications, vaccines, biosimilars, and biologics, establishing a strong global presence. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The total annual turnover of pharmaceuticals in FY24 was ₹4.17 lakh crore, growing at an average rate of 10.1 per cent in the last five years. **Exports account for 50 per cent of the total turnover, with its value at ₹2.19 lakh crore in FY24. The total import of pharmaceuticals was worth about ₹58,440.4 crore. India is currently a net exporter of pharmaceuticals,** meaning it exports more pharmaceutical products than it imports, often referred to as the "pharmacy of the world" due to its large volume of generic drug exports globally. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- **The government has taken various measures to support the sector like PLI scheme and Strengthening of Pharmaceuticals Industry (SPI) among others.**
 - PLI scheme aims to attain self-reliance and reduce import dependence in critical Key Starting Materials (KSMs)/Drug Intermediates and Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (APIs). SPI addresses the demand to support the existing pharma clusters and MSMEs across the country to improve their productivity, quality and sustainability. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 72.A

- The GOI has launched the Sagarmala program to harness India's coastline and waterways fully, improving logistics efficiency. It results in improvement in port capacity in FY25 and leads to improvements in operational efficiency and reduction in average container turnaround time.
- **The average container turnaround time in major ports has reduced from 48.1 hours in FY24 to 30.4 hours in FY25. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- **The GOI has approved the development of the VadHAVAN Mega Port with over Rs 76000 crore investment. It is located in Maharashtra (not in Gujarat). Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- In October 2024, the **National Maritime Heritage Complex in Lothal was approved**, featuring a museum with 14 galleries, the tallest lighthouse museum, India's largest Navy gallery, and themed amusement parks. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

Q 73.A

- **Recent context:** In a groundbreaking move, the Economic Survey 2024-25 has highlighted the Tim Tim Tare (TTT) initiative as a government effort to equip India's adolescent students with essential life skills.
- **Tim Tim Tare (TTT) is a pioneering initiative that aims to impart essential life skills to adolescent students across India.** Unlike vocational training, which focuses on technical skills, TTT places emphasis on soft skills—key components of personal growth, effective communication, emotional intelligence, and social well-being. Through TTT, students are empowered to face life's challenges confidently and clearly. **Hence option (a) is the correct answer.**
- This initiative equips students with essential life skills to navigate the complexities of modern life. Built on the World Health Organization's (WHO) Life Skills Framework, TTT addresses a wide range of 16 core life skills (such as empathy, critical thinking, etiquette, time management, etc) and over 100 related topics designed to meet the evolving needs of today's youth. These skills enable students to make

informed, thoughtful decisions personally and professionally and equip them with the skills and attitudes necessary to thrive in their studies and beyond.

- TTT's approach stands apart from traditional education due to its student-focused methodology, delivering content in an engaging, immersive manner and creating transformative experiences enabling students to absorb, internalise, and retain key concepts effectively. Each topic is designed with activity-based learning, such as experience sharing, role plays, sing-along songs and interactive games. This approach ensures that every lesson is lively, impactful, and engaging, allowing students to experience the learning process actively.
- **Started in 2009 in Tamil Nadu, TTT has now expanded to other states in a phased manner, reaching millions of students across India.** In addition to empowering students, TTT has prioritised training thousands of teachers across these states, ensuring that the programme's benefits are deeply rooted and widely disseminated.

Q 74.D

- National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP) has been launched in 2019. NIP is a group of infrastructure projects, which are to be executed over 5 years i.e. from FY20 to FY25. Total investment planned under NIP for these 5 financial years is Rs 111 lakh crore. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The NIP's funding is a collaborative effort involving the Central Government, State Governments, and the private sector. The expected contributions are approximately 39% from the Centre, 40% from the States, and 21% from private entities. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- Monetisation of assets is one of the strategies to fund the NIP, but it does not account for more than 50% of the funding. National Monetisation Pipeline (NMP) has been launched by GOI for a four years period (2022-25). NMP anticipates a total monetisation potential of Rs 6 lakh crore through the Central Government's core assets. But the share of monetisation is much less than 50%. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 75.C

- **UNCTAD defines NTMs as policy measures that are not ordinary customs tariffs but can still significantly impact international trade in goods. These measures can affect either the quantities traded, prices, or both.**
- **NTMs are classified into import-related and export-related categories based on the above classification. Import-related NTMs are further classified as "technical" or "non-technical."**
- **Technical measures comprise** sanitary and phytosanitary measures (SPS), technical barriers to trade (TBT), and pre-shipment inspections. **Non-technical measures encompass** traditional trade policies like quotas, subsidies, and trade remedies, including those addressing unfair trade practices.
- The decline in tariffs globally has been accompanied by an increase in the implementation of NTMs across countries. **The Global Trade Alert database shows that between 2020 and 2024, over 26,000 new restrictions related to trade and investments have been globally imposed.**
- A UNCTAD report notes that **NTMs can serve as legitimate policy instruments, fulfilling important roles such as protecting human health and the environment. In some cases, they may even enhance trade.** For instance, when an exporting country implements high sanitary and phytosanitary standards, consumers in importing countries tend to have greater confidence in the quality of the food products, which can lead to increased demand. **Stricter domestic food safety standards can also help local exporters meet the requirements of their trade partners, further boosting trade opportunities. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **CBAM** is the EU's tool to put a fair price on the carbon emitted during the production of carbon-intensive goods entering the EU and to encourage cleaner industrial production in non-EU countries.
- **The EUDR** requires operators and traders to ensure that the products placed in the EU market are (i) deforestation-free (i.e., must not be derived from a land that is deforested after December 31, 2020); (ii) should be produced following the relevant legislation of the country where the product is produced; and (iii) covers the submission of a due diligence statement before placing the products in the EU.
- **Both CBAM and EUDR are classic examples of NTMs because they impose regulatory and procedural requirements on imports, rather than imposing tariffs. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 76.A

- BharatTradeNet (BTN) is a digital public infrastructure aimed at improving international trade facilitation
- It focuses on reducing delays, streamlining trade documentation, and improving trade financing.
- It will integrate with the Unified Logistics Interface Platform (ULIP) to enhance efficiency in global trade transactions.
- **Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.**

Q 77.C

- From the gender perspective, the female labour force participation rate (FLFPR) **has been rising for seven years, i.e., from 23.3 per cent in 2017-18 to 41.7 per cent in 2023-24**, driven mainly by the rising participation of rural women.
- According to the PLFS 2023-24, the agriculture sector remains dominant in employment, with its share rising from 44.1 per cent in 2017-18 to 46.1 per cent in 2023-24. **The share of female workers in agriculture has increased significantly, from 57.0 per cent in 2017-18 to 64.4 per cent in 2023-24**, whereas, male participation in agriculture decreased from 40.2 per cent to 36.3 per cent. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **In rural areas, female agricultural employment rose from 73.2 per cent in 2017-18 to 76.9 in 2023-24 per cent**, while male participation decreased from 55.0 per cent to 49.4 per cent, reflecting a shift towards non-agricultural sectors during the same period. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Q 78.C

- The export of services grew at a trend rate of 11 per cent during FY14 to FY23, at constant prices. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- India remained amongst the top five major countries in terms of growth in services exports in FY25 (April-September). Computer services and business services exports account for around 70 per cent of India's services exports. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- India's services export growth accelerated to 12.8 per cent in April-November FY25 from 5.7 per cent in FY24. In April-November FY25, services imports grew by 13.9 per cent, in contrast to a decline of 2.9 per cent during the same period in FY24

Q 79.B

- The importance of AI integration in financial services:
 - With the pace of innovation and degree of AI integration in financial services, regulatory and supervisory, vulnerabilities could evolve. and effectiveness may take a backseat if financial regulators' AI-related skills and knowledge do not keep pace with developments in this space. **Without an appropriate governance framework, AI systems may operate without clear guidelines or oversight, leading to potential abuse or misuse of technology.**
 - Accordingly, the RBI has proactively engaged with regulated entities and experts to assess the ongoing developments while effectively communicating its expectations through multiple engagement forums.
 - It has also created a regulatory sandbox focusing on innovative technology products/services.
 - **Further, the RBI announced the establishment of a committee to create a Framework for Responsible and Ethical Enablement of Artificial Intelligence (FREE-AI) in the financial sector.**
 - It will be headed by Pushpak Bhattacharyya, Professor, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, IIT Bombay. The committee's mandate will be to study the present level of AI adoption in financial services and review regulatory and supervisory approaches on AI with a focus on the financial sector globally.
 - **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**

Q 80.C

- **As per Economic Survey 2024-25**, FPIs became net buyers in the Indian equity market starting in June 2024 after being sellers in the first two months of FY25. However, this trend reversed in October and the first half of November 2024, resulting in a net outflow of USD 11.5 billion and 2.5 billion, respectively.
- **Factors that led to the withdrawal of significant funds from Indian equities:**
 - **Rising geopolitical tensions:** The Survey highlights that geopolitical tensions have led to heightened global uncertainty, making foreign investors more risk-averse. This is one of the reasons for the outflow of Foreign Portfolio Investments (FPI) from emerging markets, including India. **Hence, option 1 is correct.**

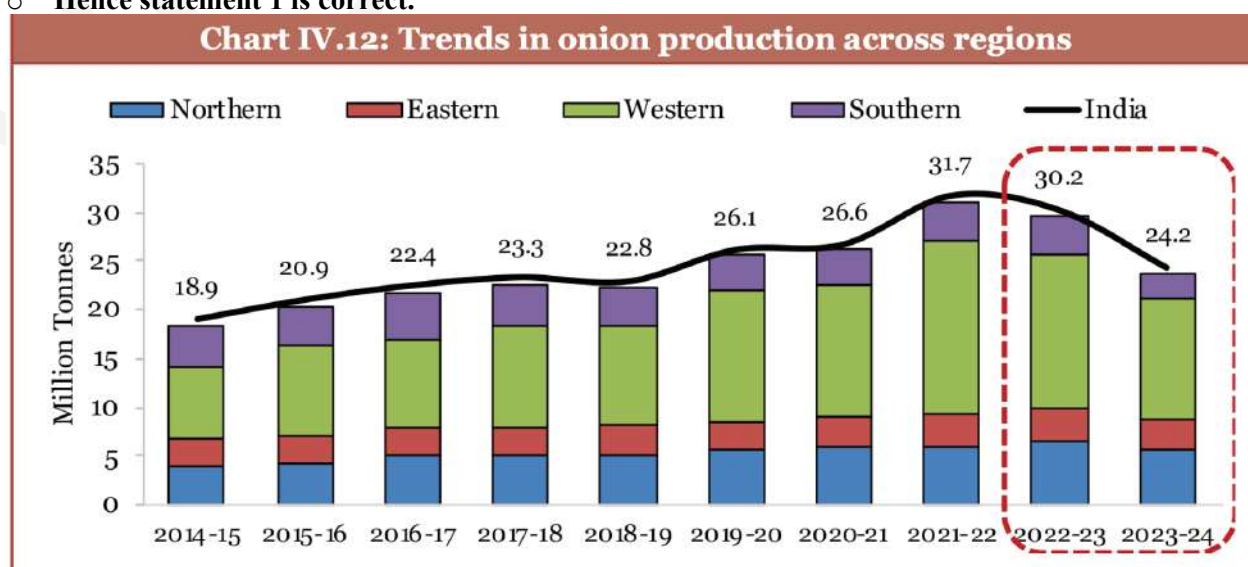
- **Recent developments in China-led FPIs:** These include the stimulus measures announced by the Chinese Government and the cheap valuation of Chinese stocks. Hence, option 3 is correct.
- **Concerns about slowing earnings growth and high valuations:** Indian equity markets have seen sharp rallies, pushing valuations to relatively higher levels. According to the Survey, high valuations make Indian stocks less attractive to foreign investors, leading to some profit booking and FPI outflows. Hence, option 4 is correct.
- Factors such as India's strong macroeconomic fundamentals, favorable business environment, and robust economic growth have encouraged investors to reverse the outflow trend.
- **The inclusion of Indian Government Bonds (IGB) in some global bond indices this year has significantly supported debt inflows.** Since the announcement of inclusion in the JP Morgan index in October 2023, there has been heightened activity in the FPI debt segment with cumulative flows of ₹ 1.1 lakh crore from October 2023 to June 2024. Hence, option 2 is not correct.
- **Further,** the investor sentiment/perception of the trajectory of Fed rates and the interest rate differentials are the key drivers of FPI flows in India, the yield gap between India and US10 year yields, which shows that a widening yield differential in India's favor leads to higher inflows (November 2023 to March 2024) and vice-versa.

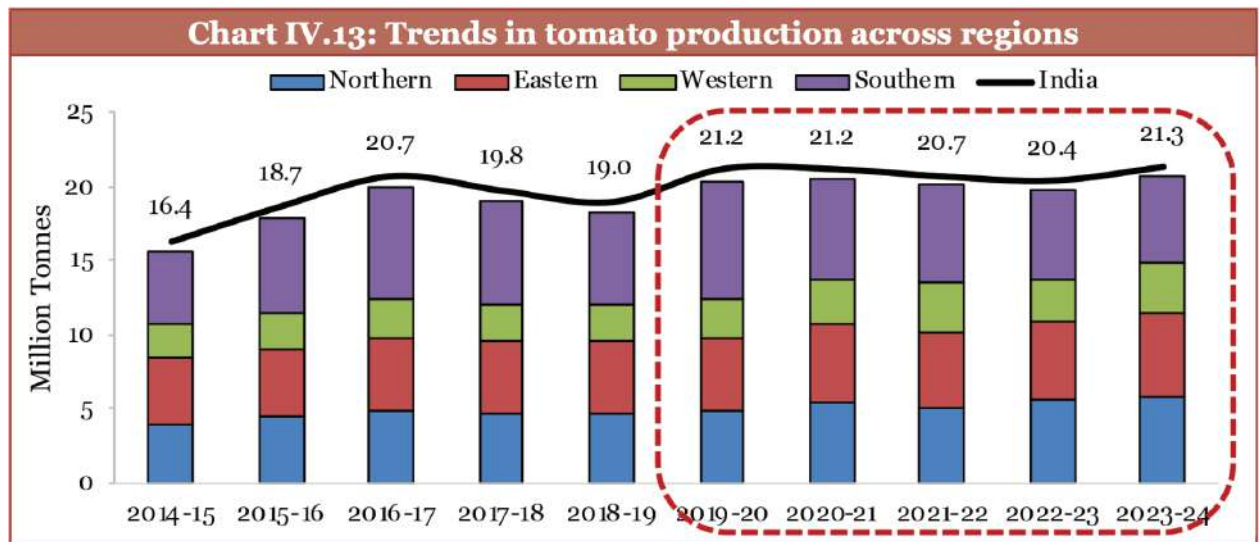
Q 81.A

- The Makhana Board will be established in Bihar, which is the largest producer of Makhana (fox nuts) in India. This initiative aims to improve production, processing, and value addition. Hence, statement 1 is correct.
- A major objective of the board is to organize farmers into Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs). This will help in better price realization, collective bargaining, and enhanced market access. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- The board primarily focuses on domestic processing, value addition, and marketing, not just exports. It aims to strengthen the Makhana supply chain within India and improve farmer earnings rather than prioritizing exports. Hence, statement 3 is not correct.

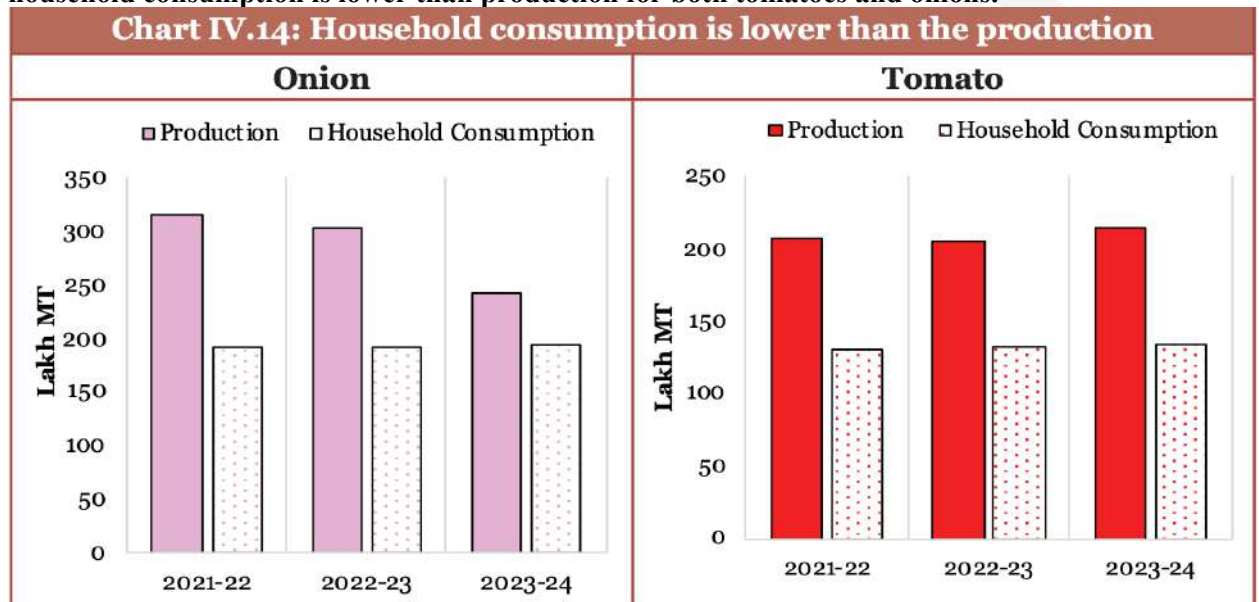
Q 82.A

- The inflationary pressures in onion remained firm in FY24 and the current year, despite prompt measures by the government to contain prices due to constrained supply resulting from reduced production.
 - **Onions are grown in both the Kharif and Rabi seasons, with around 70 per cent of production occurring during the Rabi season.**
- The price pressures in tomatoes remained intermittently high since FY23 due to constrained supply.
- Tomato production is mainly concentrated in states such as Madhya Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Gujarat and Odisha. This regional concentration makes the supply chain vulnerable to disruptions in any of these areas.
- **Similar to onions, a major portion of tomato production - more than 65 per cent - occurs in the Rabi season.**
 - Hence statement 1 is correct.





- Thus, the combined production of Tomatoes and Onions is 45.5 million tonnes in 2023-24. Hence statement 2 is not correct.
- Analysis of production and consumption trends over the past three years shows that domestic household consumption is lower than production for both tomatoes and onions.



- Hence statement 3 is not correct.

Q 83.D

- The Union Budget 2025-26 was presented by the Finance Minister with the theme "Sabka Vikas", emphasizing inclusive growth, social welfare, and economic empowerment for all sections of society.
- This aligns with the government's long-term vision of "Viksit Bharat 2047", aiming for sustainable and equitable economic development.
- Previous budget themes have included 'Amrit Kaal' (2023-24) and 'Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas'.
- Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q 84.D

- India's Space Vision 2047 outlines an ambitious roadmap for the nation's space exploration and technological advancements.
- As part of India's Space Vision 2047, the Union Cabinet has approved four key projects: the Gaganyaan follow-on mission, which will pave the way for the establishment of the first module of the Bhartiya Antariksh Station; the Chandrayaan-4 Lunar Sample Return Mission; the Venus Orbiter Mission; and the development of the Next Generation Launch Vehicle.
- The Chandrayaan-4 Lunar Sample Return Mission aims to collect and return the lunar sample to Earth, marking a significant milestone in India's lunar exploration efforts. Hence, option 1 is correct.

- The Venus Orbiter Mission is designed to study various aspects of Venus, including its surface and atmosphere, expanding India's planetary exploration portfolio. **Hence, option 2 is correct.**
- The NISAR Mission is a collaborative project between NASA and ISRO, focusing on Earth observation. While significant, it is not explicitly part of India's Space Vision 2047. **Hence, option 3 is not correct.**
- The development of the Next Generation Launch Vehicle aims to enhance India's launch capabilities, supporting a range of missions from satellite deployments to interplanetary exploration. **Hence, option 4 is correct.**
- The development of the Reusable Launch Vehicle focuses on creating cost-effective and sustainable access to space. However, it is not explicitly part of India's Space Vision 2047. **Hence, option 5 is not correct.**

Q 85.A

- The Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM), 2003, was enacted to ensure fiscal prudence, reduce fiscal and revenue deficits, and promote macroeconomic stability. It sets targets for fiscal deficit reduction and transparent government borrowing.
- The FRBM Act originally applied only to the central government.
 - However, based on the 12th Finance Commission's recommendations, states also adopted Fiscal Responsibility Legislations (FRLs).
 - Hence, both the central and state governments are required to maintain fiscal discipline. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The original FRBM Act aimed to eliminate the revenue deficit, but later amendments removed the mandatory zero revenue deficit requirement.
 - The FRBM (Amendment) Act, 2018, shifted focus to gradual reduction rather than complete elimination. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**
- The FRBM Act allows deviations from deficit targets in extraordinary circumstances, such as:
 - War or national security threats.
 - Severe economic crises (e.g., COVID-19 pandemic).
 - Structural reforms requiring additional government spending.

Q 86.C

- The Pradhan Mantri Dhan Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDKY) is a significant agricultural initiative announced in the Union Budget 2025-26, aiming to enhance agricultural productivity and support farmers in specific districts.
- It targets 100 districts characterized by low productivity, moderate cropping intensity, and below-average credit parameters. **It is not specific to 117 Aspirational Districts. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- **It focuses on five key objectives:**
 - Enhancing agricultural productivity,
 - Adopting crop diversification and sustainable agriculture practices,
 - Augmenting post-harvest storage at the panchayat and block level,
 - Improving irrigation facilities and
 - **Facilitating availability of long-term and short-term credit. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The provision of financial assistance is there under this scheme. **However, the financing is not provided as a Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) to farmers but to support them as a loan with a low interest rate to enhance agricultural infrastructure. Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 87.B

- The Economy Survey highlights that as the world navigates the challenges of climate change, the road to energy transition runs through China. The reason for this is the dominance of China in the renewable energy sector. China's share of solar panels (polysilicon, ingots, wafers, cells, and modules) exceeds 80 percent in all the manufacturing stages. Interestingly, this is more than double China's share of global PV demand. On the solar front, China controls the supply of primary materials, manufacturing, installed capacity, and recycling capacity and produces at least 80 percent of the main components of PVs. In addition, the country is home to the world's top 10 suppliers of solar PV manufacturing equipment.
- **About 60 percent (less than three-fourths or 75%) of the world's wind-installed capacity is sourced from China. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- China houses nearly 80 percent of the world's battery manufacturing capacity, which is pivotal to the energy transition. In 2022 alone, China allocated USD 546 billion towards various investments in solar

and wind energy, electric vehicles, and battery technologies vis-à-vis US and EU investments in these sectors, which amounted to USD 321 billion in the same year. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- It is also pertinent to note that about 70 percent of the world's rare earth minerals, which are critical resources for high-storage batteries, are processed by Chinese companies. **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 88.C

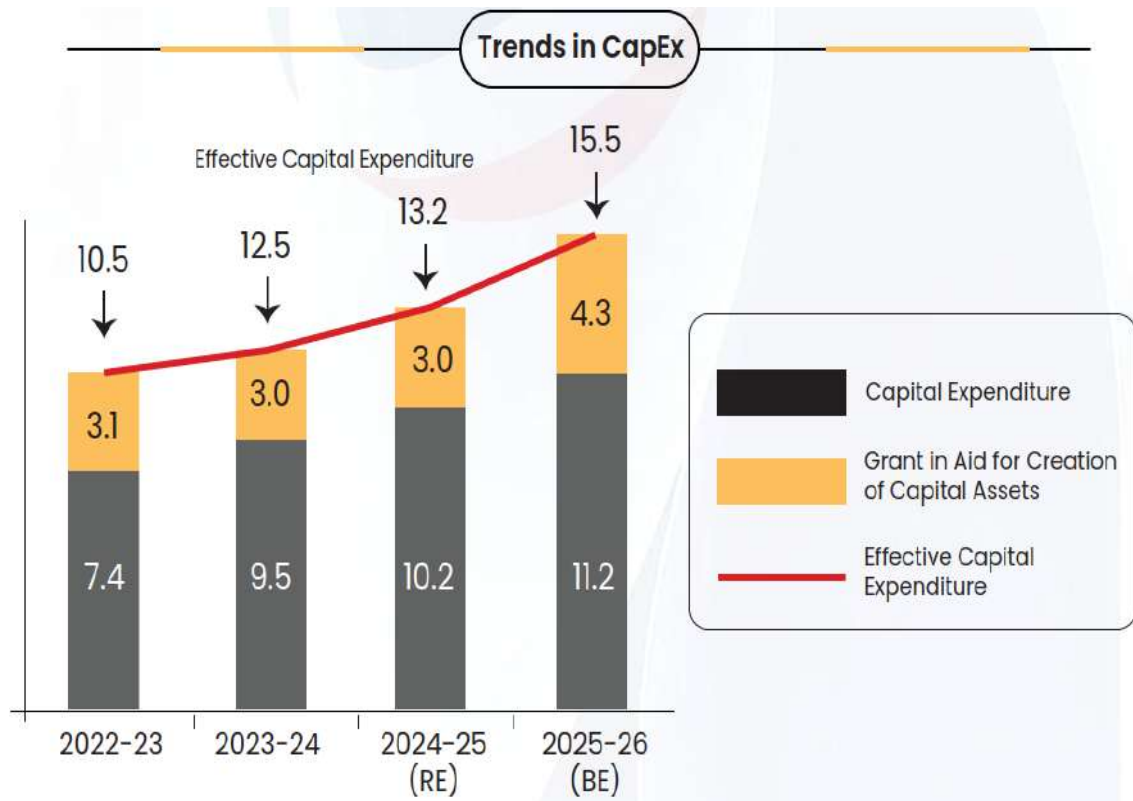
- NITI Aayog working paper on “Identifying Potential Service Sub-Sectors: Insights from GVA, Exports, and Employment Data” studies the potential of services in transforming the Indian economy from various dimensions such as the contribution to output /value added, employment and exports. Based on the analysis of the performance of the various service sub-sectors on these key dimensions, services are classified into four categories each with its own set of policy recommendations: defend, accelerate, transform, and untapped.
- **Sectors to defend:**
 - sectors with high export & GVA, low employment share
 - computer & information services, professional, scientific & other business services
- **Sectors to accelerate**
 - sectors with low-moderate export, moderate-high GVA & employment share
 - trade & repair, transport, education, financial services
- **Sectors to transform**
 - sectors with low export, GVA & employment share
 - travel, health, personal, cultural & recreational services
- **Untapped sectors**
 - sectors with negligible export, GVA & employment share
 - telecommunications, insurance & pension services, AV & related services, postal & courier
- **Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.**

Q 89.B

- **Fertigation is a method of fertilizer application in which fertilizer is incorporated within the irrigation water by the drip system.** In this system, fertilizer solution is distributed evenly throughout the irrigation. The availability of nutrients is very high; therefore, the efficiency is higher. **In this method, liquid fertilizers, as well as water-soluble fertilizers, are used.** This method increases fertilizer use efficiency from 80 to 90 percent. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- **Sulfur-coated Urea (Urea Gold)** is being introduced in the country for the first time as a part of the package of innovative schemes for the farmers. It is more economical and efficient than the currently used neem-coated urea. **It addresses a sulfur deficiency in the country's soil.** It also saves input costs for the farmers and raises incomes for farmers with enhanced production & productivity. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**
- The primary goal of the PM-PRANAM is to address a pressing issue – the excessive use of chemical fertilizers and pesticides in agriculture. In pursuit of higher production, excess use of fertilizers and pesticides makes Mother Earth sick and reduces its production capacity. **PM-PRANAM initiative incentivizes states to adopt alternative fertilizers such as Nano Urea, Nano Diammonium phosphate (DAP), and organic fertilizers.** By promoting these sustainable options, the government aims to improve soil health, reduce environmental pollution, and boost agricultural productivity. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**

Q 90.C

- Capital expenditure has consistently increased over the last three years, showing the government's strong commitment to infrastructure growth.
 - In Budget 2025-26, capital expenditure increased to ₹15.5 lakh crore, marking a continued upward trend. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - The focus remains on roads, railways, energy, and urban development, contributing to long-term economic growth.
- Effective Capital Expenditure includes both capital outlay and grants-in-aid for capital asset creation.
 - A significant portion of effective capital expenditure is not allocated to grants-in-aid for capital asset creation.
 - Direct spending on physical infrastructure projects and defense capital outlay contribute significantly.
 - **Hence, statement II is not correct.**



Q 91.C

- Presently, given the resource endowments, coal cannot be neglected as a reliable and affordable source of energy for India's development. India has, however, taken a leading role in climate action, with the government implementing measures to reduce emissions in the economy. **One key strategy has been to promote the efficient use of coal by utilising super-critical (SC), ultra-super-critical (USC) and the recent Advanced Ultra Super Critical (AUSC) technologies in coal-based power plants. Back in 2010, India commissioned its first power unit based on supercritical technology, and by the middle of 2024, a total capacity of 65,290 megawatts (94 Units) and 4,240 megawatts (06 units) in supercritical and ultra-supercritical technology-based power units have been commissioned respectively.** Further, more recently, the National Thermal Power Corporation Limited (NTPC) and Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL) have developed an **Indigenous Advance Ultra Super Critical (AUSC) technology** and are setting up an 800-megawatt AUSC technology-based Thermal Power Plant. This AUSC power plant will reduce emissions by about 11 per cent compared to super-critical plants.
- Conventional coal-fired power plants, which make water boil to generate steam that activates a turbine, have efficiency of about 32%.
- **Supercritical (SC) and ultra-supercritical (USC) power plants operate at temperatures and pressures above the critical point of water, i.e. above the temperature and pressure at which the liquid and gas phases of water coexist in equilibrium, at which point there is no difference between water gas and liquid water. This results in higher efficiencies – above 45%. Hence option (c) is the correct answer.**
 - Supercritical technology: Operates at pressures above 22.1 MPa and temperatures above 540°C.
 - Ultra-supercritical technology: Pushes these limits even higher, with temperatures reaching around 600°C or more, leading to even better efficiency and lower emissions.

Q 92.C

- **Tur dal also contributed to food inflation in India. The deficient production of tur in 2022-23 and 2023-24 has indeed led to high price pressures in tur dal during FY24 and FY25 (April-December), despite various measures by the government to shore up the supply in consuming regions.**
- **Production declined by 13.6 per cent in 2022-23 and 10.8 per cent in 2023-24 compared to the last 5-year average, affecting the supply. Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- **As a major Kharif pulse,** tur is harvested from November to January, with its price impact mainly observed in the subsequent financial year.
 - **Hence statement 1 is correct.**

- Despite these challenges, the government is actively working to ensure an adequate supply of tur dal to consumers. To ensure that the produced quantity reaches the market and to prevent stockpiling, the government is taking proactive measures by periodically imposing stock limits for tur, and active monitoring through the stock disclosure portal.
- **Further, to meet the demand for tur, the country imported 7.7 lakh tonnes of tur in FY24, mainly from Mozambique, Tanzania, Malawi, and Myanmar. Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 93.A

- Inland fisheries contribute more to total fish production than marine fisheries.
 - Over 70% of India's total fish production comes from inland fisheries, mainly due to the rapid expansion of aquaculture in states like Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal, and Odisha.
 - Marine fisheries contribute less than 30% due to sustainability concerns and regulatory limits on deep-sea fishing. **Hence, statement 1 is not correct.**
- India ranks second globally in total fish production and aquaculture, after China.
 - The fisheries sector is a major contributor to food security, exports, and employment. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The fisheries sector in India contributes around 1.07% to the country's GDP, not 6%.
 - The fisheries sector contributes around 6.7% to the Gross Value Added (GVA) of the Agriculture and Allied Sectors in India.
 - While the sector is important for employment and rural development, its direct contribution to GDP remains below 2%.
 - **Hence, statement 3 is not correct.**

Q 94.B

- On a longer-term basis, Indian markets have been among the bestperforming markets in the world.
- **On 23 May 2024, the total market capitalisation of BSE-listed stocks closed above the USD 5 trillion milestone for the first time. Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- At the end of December 2024, BSE's market capitalisation increased by 14.2 per cent since March 2024 to reach ₹445.2 lakh crore.
- **Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) market capitalisation to GDP ratio stood at 136 per cent at the end of December 2024, rising significantly over the last 10 years. Hence statement 2 is correct.**

Table II.1: Market capitalisation to nominal GDP ratio (percentage)

	India	China	Brazil	Japan	South Korea	United Kingdom	United States
Dec-19	77	60	65	121	89	106	158
Dec-20	95	79	68	129	122	92	195
Dec-21	113	80	50	136	127	108	206
Dec-22	105	65	42	126	96	91	157
Dec-23	124	61	44	147	114	71	179
Dec-24*	136	65	37	157	90	84	213

- **Hence statement 3 not correct.**

Q 95.A

- While the outpacing of merchandise imports over merchandise exports widened India's merchandise trade deficit in FY24, India's services trade surplus has lent balance to the overall trade deficit.
 - **India's robust services exports have propelled the country to secure the seventh-largest share in global services exports, underscoring its competitiveness. Hence statement 1 is not correct.**
- **India's foreign exchange reserves increased from USD 616.7 billion at the end of January 2024 to USD 704.9 billion in September 2024 before moderating to USD 634.6 billion as on 3 January 2025.**
 - India's forex reserves are sufficient to cover 90 per cent of external debt and provide an import cover of more than ten months, thereby safeguarding against external vulnerabilities. **Hence statement 3 is correct.**
- **As per the World Bank, India is still the top recipient of remittances in the world.**
 - In 2024, India received an estimated \$129.1 billion worth of remittances. **Hence statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 96.D

- The Bharat Brand is a government initiative designed to provide essential goods, including food grains, to the middle class at subsidized prices.
- **Product Range:** The Bharat Brand encompasses a variety of staples such as rice, flour (atta), and pulses (dal).
 - These products are priced substantially lower than those offered by other market competitors.
- For instance, Bharat Rice is available at ₹29 per kg on e-commerce platforms.

Box IV.1: Administrative measures to control food inflation	
Food items	Measures undertaken
Cereals	• Stock limits on wheat from 24 June 2024 to 31 March 2025. • Open Market Sale Scheme: Offloaded wheat and rice from the central pool • Sale of wheat flour and rice under Bharat brand
Pulses	• Sale of chana dal, moong dal and masur dal under Bharat brand • Stock limits on tur and desi chana from 21 June 2024 to 30 September 2024 • Allowed duty-free import of desi chana, tur, urad and masur until 31 March 2025. • Allowed duty free import of yellow peas until 20 February 2025.
Vegetables	• Buffer Stock of Onion: A total of 4.7 lakh MT of rabi onion has been procured under Price Stabilisation Fund. • 20 per cent export duty on onion since 13 September 2024. • Subsidised sale of onion at ₹35 per kg from September -December 2024. • Subsidised sale of Tomato at ₹65 per kg in October 2024

- Hence option (d) is the correct answer.

Q 97.A

- India's services sector has been the steadiest contributor to the gross value added (GVA) in the economy. Its contribution to the total GVA at current prices has increased from 50.6 per cent in FY14 to about 55 per cent in FY25.
- **India's share in global services exports has been steadily rising for the last two decades.** This has helped compensate the impact of oscillation in the share of merchandise exports in global merchandise exports to some extent. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **India ranks seventh globally, representing a 4.3 per cent share in the global services export.** In 2023, the United States led global services exports with a dominant 13 per cent share, followed by the United Kingdom with 7.4 per cent, Germany with 5.5 per cent and Ireland, China, and France, each accounting for approximately 5 per cent. **Hence, statement 2 is not correct.**

Q 98.C

- The domestic corporate debt market continued to gain significant traction during 2024. The value of corporate bond issuances stood at ₹7.3 lakh crore from April to December 2024.
- Private placements remained the preferred channel for corporates, accounting for 99.1 percent of total resources mobilised through the bond market.
- **As a percentage of GDP, the corporate bond market is only 18 percent in India,** as opposed to 80 percent in Korea and 36 percent in China. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**
- The market for corporate bonds comprises high-end bonds, with 97 percent of corporate bond issuances concentrated in the top 3 rating categories (AAA, AA+ and AA).
- Issuers who are unable to get these ratings are unable to access the bond market. **This may explain why most issuers of corporate bonds are NBFCs or public sector undertakings (PSUs).**
- **An overwhelming majority of corporate bond issuance happens through the route of private placement, which actively deters the participation of retail investors.** In FY24, the public placement

of corporate bonds stood at ₹19,000 crore against the private placement of around ₹8,38,000 crore. **Hence statement 2 is correct.**

- The financial services sector dominates the issuance of corporate bonds at nearly 60 percent of the total.
- Outside financial services, real estate and power generation/ supply comprise the rest. Consequently, corporate bond issuance from manufacturing and non-energy infrastructure sectors is a very small proportion of the overall bond market.
 - From April to December 2024, ₹16,456 crore was raised by Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) and Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs).

Q 99.C

- **Recent Context:** A rare pair of the White-winged duck was spotted in the Dihing Patkai National Park (Assam).
- The White-winged Duck primarily feeds on aquatic plants, seeds, insects, and small fish. It was once distributed widely across north-east India and south-east Asia. But now, only about 800 survive in the wild of which about 450 are present in India, Bangladesh and Myanmar. In India, the duck is limited to Assam and Arunachal Pradesh. Due to its ghostly call, it is called 'Deo Hans' or Spirit Duck in Assamese. **Hence statement (d) is not correct.**
- It mostly resides in dense tropical evergreen forest and is known to prefer inaccessible swampy areas formed by numerous rivers, streams, etc. The duck is generally found in pairs or in small parties of four to six, though parties of more than 10 are also recorded. It loves shade and spends most of the day in secluded jungle pools, occasionally perching on the trees during the day. **Hence statement (b) is not correct.**
- **Characteristics:**
 - Secretive Birds: They are shy and hard to spot in the wild.
 - Tree Nesters: They nest in tree cavities near water.
 - Nocturnal: They are mostly active at night. **Hence statement (c) is correct.**
 - Diverse Diet: They eat plants, seeds, insects, and small fish.
 - Others: it's a State bird of Assam and called 'Deo Hanh' (spirit duck) in Assamese.
- **Protection:** Schedule I under Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972; White-winged Duck Conservation Strategy and Action Plan 2022, formulated by the Assam government and Wildlife Trust of India; **IUCN Red List: Critically Endangered. Hence statement (a) is not correct.**

Q 100.B

- **Fluoxetine (Prozac) & its effects on guppy fish**
 - **Context:** A recent study has revealed that long-term exposure to fluoxetine (Prozac) can significantly disrupt the behavior and reproductive traits of male guppy fish.
 - **Fluoxetine (Prozac):**
 - > An antidepressant belonging to the group of serotonin selective reuptake inhibitors (SSRIs). **Hence option (b) is the correct answer.**
 - > Increases the amount of serotonin, a natural chemical in the brain.
 - **Effects of Low Concentrations on Male Guppies:**
 - > Reduced activity levels.
 - > Increased refuge-seeking behavior.
 - > Altered body condition.
 - > Enlarged reproductive organs.
 - > Reduced sperm velocity.
 - > Decreased flexibility in responding to environmental changes.
 - **Effects of High Concentrations on Male Guppies:**
 - > Increased variability in body condition and sperm production.
 - > Altered 'pace of life syndromes'.
 - > Larger reproductive organs are linked to lower sperm quality.

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